

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Torch of the Jewels, a Mahāyāna Sūtra

Ārya-Ratnolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 847 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་དཀར་མཆོད་ལ་ལའི་གཟུངས་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེ་པའི་མཛན་

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Torch of the Jewels, a Mahāyāna Sūtra (Sanskrit: Ārya-ratnolkā-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra; Tibetan: 'phags pa dkon mchog ta la la'i gzungs zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo) is a Mahāyāna sūtra centered on a dhāraṇī, a formula of protective and purifying power. As the opening lines indicate, it is set at Vulture Peak Mountain in Rājagṛha, where the Buddha is gathered with a great assembly of monks and a retinue of bodhisattvas, including Samantabhadra. It is Toh 847 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the general class of tantra, as the colophon-style note on the "third tantra" at the head of the text suggests, even though it is framed as a sūtra and contains a dhāraṇī.

May the teaching be protected. The third tantra is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya-Ratnolka-nāma-dhāraṇī-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Torch of the Jewels, a Mahāyāna Sūtra. First chapter.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak Mountain, together with a great assembly of the Saṅgha, one thousand monks in full. All of them were perfect in the white factors, roaring the great lion's roar, skilled in seeking the immeasurable accumulations of wisdom, and they were all great and eminent monks.

There was also a great assembly of bodhisattvas, namely: the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra; the bodhisattva, the great being Ratnamudrāhasta (Jewel Seal in Hand); the bodhisattva, the great being Nityodyukta (Constantly Diligent); the bodhisattva, the great being Guṇālaṃkṛta (Adorned with Qualities); the bodhisattva, the great being Puṇyaprakāśa (Proclaimer of Merit); the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāmāti (Great Intelligence); the bodhisattva, the great being Guṇavyūha (Array of Qualities); the bodhisattva, the great being Vajramāti (Diamond Intelligence); the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha (Diamond Essence); the bodhisattva, the great being Vajraprabha (Diamond Radiance); the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrāyudha (Diamond Weapon); the

bodhisattva, the great being Vajradṛḍha (Diamond Firmness); the bodhisattva, the great being Dharaṇīṃdhara (Earth-Holder); the bodhisattva, the great being Dhāraṇīmāti (Intelligence of Dhāraṇī); the bodhisattva, the great being Sarvārthadarśin (Seeing All Aims); the bodhisattva, the great being Avalokiteśvara; the bodhisattva, the great being Mahāsthāmaprāpta (Attainer of Great Power); the bodhisattva, the great being Sthiramati (Steadfast Intelligence); the bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi; the bodhisattva, the great being Mañjuśrī, the Youthful; the bodhisattva, the great being Apāyajaha (Abandoner of the Lower Realms); the bodhisattva, the great being Sarvaśokatamonirghātana (Dispeller of All Sorrow and Darkness); the bodhisattva, the great being Pravaravikrāmin (Overwhelmer through Excellent Prowess); the bodhisattva, the great being Anupādānāvisarjana (Neither Grasping nor Discarding); the bodhisattva, the great being Candanagarbha (Sandalwood Essence); the bodhisattva, the great being Sāgaramati (Ocean of Intelligence); the bodhisattva, the great being Durlabhaprabhava (Rare Arising); the bodhisattva, the great being Nandotpāda (Arising of Joy); the bodhisattva, the great being Caryāmāti (Intelligence of Conduct); the bodhisattva, the great being Pratibhānakūṭa (Heap of Eloquence); the bodhisattva, the great being Śīghragarbha (Swift Essence); and the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya.

These and other bodhisattvas, great beings, were present. They abided in the inconceivable liberation. They had come forth through the absorption of heroic progress. Their voices were unobstructed. They were skilled in overpowering countless buddha fields. They abided in fearlessness, free from attachment and from resentful anger. They were endowed with pleasing voices, unattached to the three realms, and endowed with unbroken retinues. They were born from omniscience itself, endowed with limitless absorptions and meditative attainments, and they fulfilled all hopes.

They had realized and fully comprehended the Perfection of Wisdom. They were devoted to making their actions of body, speech, and mind meaningful. They strove toward omniscience itself. They were blessed with immeasurable absorptions and conduct. They had attained fearlessness, they ranged in the domain of emptiness, and they abided in the signless. They were such as these, and many others besides.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being named Samantabhadra, who had come to be seated in that very assembly, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these words to the Blessed One. "Blessed One, how should the

dharmadhātu, the basic space of phenomena, be realized?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is to be realized as without inherent existence. Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is like space itself. It is free of elaboration, it is unelaborated, there is nothing to take up and nothing to cast away, it is without inherent existence, and it is without abiding. It should be realized in just this way."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked, "Blessed One, does the basic space of phenomena arise?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is without arising. Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is inconceivable. Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is realized as without inherent existence, and so it cannot be expressed or demonstrated as any thing whatsoever."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked, "Blessed One, how many kinds of awakening are there?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, the kinds of awakening are immeasurable, and they cannot be taught as having any limit."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked, "Blessed One, does one conceptualize the basic space of phenomena?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, the basic space of phenomena is free of conceptualization."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked, "Blessed One, if the basic space of phenomena is free of conceptualization, why do ordinary childish beings conceptualize?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, all ordinary childish beings arise from conceptual thought, from discursive conceptualization, and from thorough imputation."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Blessed One, this awakening of the Tathāgatas is profound."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, so it is. It is just as you have said. Moreover, son of good family, the absence of elaboration in all phenomena is called awakening."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, who had come to be seated in that very assembly, bowed his head to the feet of the Blessed One and spoke these

words to the Blessed One. "Blessed One, please teach the dhāraṇī called Tala-tala of the Jewel."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra here, who abides in unobstructed eloquence regarding all phenomena. He will teach you."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, sat facing the Blessed One, joined his ten fingers in homage, and spoke these words to the Blessed One. "Blessed One, you who know all and see all, why do you yourself not teach it?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, where bodhisattvas endowed with such qualities as these are present, there the Tathāgatas rest in equanimity."

Mañjuśrī said, "Blessed One, the Tathāgatas do not rest in equanimity."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, I do not abandon the realm of sentient beings to ruin. Nevertheless, son of good family, the teaching of the bodhisattvas is a teaching without measure, a teaching beyond conception."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, again spoke these words to the Blessed One. "May the Blessed One teach the dhāraṇī called the Jewel Talala."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra here, and he will teach you. Why is this? Son of good family, this supreme being abides in the gathering of wisdom."

Mañjuśrī said, "If the Tathāgata is mindful of me, I shall ask this supreme being."

The Blessed One said, "Mañjuśrī, you have attained meditative absorptions as numerous as the particles of dust in the finest atom. Why then must you make requests of the Tathāgata? Son of good family, you are fortunate in all the qualities of a buddha."

Mañjuśrī said, "Blessed One, whatever qualities of a buddha I have relied upon, meditated upon, and practiced extensively, I shall understand all of them as arising through the power of the Tathāgata's own being."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent, son of good family! You have spoken these words well. Nevertheless, Mañjuśrī, I make this request of you: ask the bodhisattva Samantabhadra."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, spoke these words to the Blessed One. "Blessed One, this bodhisattva Samantabhadra teaches the exceedingly profound; he has fully comprehended and realized the Great Vehicle."

The Blessed One said, "Son of good family, you too are the sovereign king of power over all phenomena, so do not say this of me. Moreover, son of good family, you possess the inconceivable meditative absorption that abides in emptiness."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, joined his ten fingers in homage to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, and spoke these words to him. "O son of the Victor, if you grant me the opportunity, I shall ask you two syllables."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Son of good family, if you know how to bring it to its proper time, ask."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra. "O son of the Victor, what is the meaning of the ground of the word 'buddha, buddha'?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "O son of the Victor, the meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being without ground. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being without real entity. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of the inconceivable. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of the unequal and the equal. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being without elaboration. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of non-elaboration. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being without grasping. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being without rejecting. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of being like space. The meaning of the ground of a buddha is the meaning of the inexpressible. Son of good family, such is the intrinsic nature of the qualities of a buddha."

Mañjuśrī said, "O son of the Victor, if all phenomena are free of elaboration, then how are the qualities of a buddha taught as knowable?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "O son of the Victor, this teaching is a teaching that cannot be taught."

Mañjuśrī said,

"O son of the Victor, if there is nothing to be taught, then what is taught?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Mañjuśrī, what cannot be taught is taught through designation."

Mañjuśrī said, "O son of the Victor, what does designation designate?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Mañjuśrī, designation designates neither things nor the absence of things."

Mañjuśrī said, "O son of the Victor, if designation designates neither things nor the absence of things, then how are the three vehicles taught?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Mañjuśrī, do not cling to the dharmadhātu, which is free of clinging. Why is this? Mañjuśrī, it is because the Tathāgata has taught that all phenomena are without substantial reality. And why are they without substantial reality? Because the five aggregates are not apprehended as objects."

Mañjuśrī said, "Is awakening accompanied by elaboration, or is it free of elaboration?"

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said, "Son of good family, awakening is neither accompanied by elaboration nor free of elaboration. For awakening, that which is accompanied by elaboration, and that which is free of elaboration are not two; they cannot be divided into two."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva, the great being Samantabhadra, saying, "Son of good family, well done, well done, this teaching of the inconceivable." And by this discourse, the world with its gods was bewildered.

Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said, "Blessed One, a teaching of Dharma such as this cannot be conceived in any of its aspects."

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, so it is. It is just as you have said."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, are all phenomena designated by this designation?"

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, so it is. It is just as you have said."

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, this gateway of purity is difficult to have faith in."

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, so it is. It is just as you have said."

Then the bodhisattva Matisāgara (Ocean of Intelligence) said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra has spoken well in teaching this gateway of purity."

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, so it is. It is just as you have said. Moreover, son of good family, this is in accord with the nature of all phenomena. This is the great rain of Dharma."

Then a brahmin, like a great śāla tree, abiding in equality, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, awakening is equality, and it is inconceivable. In it, no letters are found, and no words are found."

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, so it is. In the dharmadhātu, no words appear, and no meaning appears either."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, what is that which accords with emptiness? What are its aspects? What are its signs? What are its marks?"

The Blessed One declared, "Mañjuśrī, emptiness is inexpressible and unspeakable. Whatever faith there is in this inexpressible nature of reality is called emptiness. Emptiness is without letters, and for that reason it is called emptiness. Emptiness is unspeakable, and for that reason it is called emptiness."

Son of good family, all phenomena are empty of the intrinsic nature of phenomena.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, behold the miraculous display of those bodhisattvas who abide in the inconceivable Dharma."

The Blessed One declared, "Venerable Śāriputra, the knowledge of a bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought of awakening is supreme, and the knowledge of an arhat is not like that. Why is this? The arhat remains far from the qualities of a buddha, whereas that bodhisattva will become a buddha, a Blessed One."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Sovereign King of All Phenomena, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, as I understand what the Blessed One has said, the śrāvaka has not attained the qualities of a śrāvaka."

The Blessed One declared, "Son of good family, it is not that the śrāvaka has failed to attain the qualities of a śrāvaka. Rather, how could a śrāvaka possibly have the capacity or the power to answer questions put together with a bodhisattva, or to uphold the blessing of a bodhisattva's conduct?"

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, if the Tathāgata has taught that this Śāriputra is foremost among those endowed with wisdom, to whom, then, is this teaching taught?"

The Blessed One declared, "Mañjuśrī, what I teach is without anything taught."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, spoke to the elder Śāriputra. "Elder, have you attained the qualities of a śrāvaka?" He replied, "That is not so." Mañjuśrī said, "Then are you an ordinary person?" He replied, "That is not so." Mañjuśrī said, "Then are you a trainee?" He replied, "That is not so." Mañjuśrī said, "Then are you the foremost of those endowed with wisdom?" He replied, "That is not so." Mañjuśrī said, "Venerable Śāriputra, if you are not an ordinary person, nor a trainee, nor the foremost of those endowed with wisdom, then you yourself have become one who has a fixed reference point."

Śāriputra replied, "Son of good family, I am a supreme person, as hard to fathom as the ocean, and I will not compete with you."

Mañjuśrī said, "Venerable Śāriputra, you are the eldest and the foremost of the elders. Venerable Śāriputra, do not speak in that way."

The elder replied, "Son of good family, by the mere fact of being old, one attains nothing and realizes nothing. Son of good family, in order that you may understand this very point, I will give you an example. Son of good family, just as a mere thunderbolt can shatter even a great mountain of rock, so too, son of good family, the wisdom that dwells in a single pore of your skin is not found in beings like me, even as many as the specks of dust in a fine particle. Son of good family, so that you may understand this very point, I will give you another example. Just as a great elephant, an exceedingly unruly and mighty bull elephant, is tamed with a small goad by a man who has strength, so too, son of good family, you are the one who has strength and I am the weak one. How could I contend with one such as this great elephant?"

Then the elder Śāriputra said to the Blessed One as follows.

Blessed One, it is like this. Suppose a blind man travels along a path. If he cannot even perceive a city, how could he possibly find the way from house to house within it? That is simply impossible. In just this way, in the presence of these great elephants, I see myself as like a blind man. For these qualities of the buddhas are so vast. I have not become a vessel for the qualities of the buddhas, and there is nothing at all that I can do.

The Blessed One said: Son of Śāradvatī, do not speak in this way. Son of Śāradvatī, it is like this. However many beings are touched by the light of the Tathāgata, all of them obtain the qualities of the buddhas. Son of Śāradvatī, in just this way, you have attained a meditative absorption that is boundless and beyond conception.

When the Blessed One taught this discourse on the Dharma, ninety-two thousand beings among the gods and humans came to realize the Dharma directly.

Then the bodhisattva Dharmamati entered the bodhisattva absorption called Boundless Application, Engagement with the Jewel Tāla. As soon as the bodhisattva Dharmamati had entered it, in each of the ten directions, beyond as many world-systems as there are specks of dust in a fine particle of ten thousand buddha-fields, there appeared before him as many buddhas, blessed ones, as there are specks of dust in a fine particle of ten thousand buddha-fields. All those buddhas, blessed ones, were in complete accord in bearing the name Vajragarbha. As it was in one direction, so it was in all ten directions. Those buddhas, blessed ones, spoke to him as follows.

Dharmamati, excellent, excellent, that you have entered the bodhisattva absorption of Boundless Application. Son of good family, it is thus. By the former aspiration and former blessing of this very Blessed One, the Tathāgata Vairocana, and supported by the roots of virtue that are your own, all this is so: in order that all phenomena be taught; that the wisdom of the buddhas be purified; that the wisdom of the buddhas be increased; that beings enter the dharmadhātu; that the realm of sentient beings be liberated; that you enter and fully penetrate the wisdom without attachment; that you be completely joined to it; that all languages be spoken; that you enter the wisdom of omniscience; that you be free of obscuration regarding all phenomena; and that you engage in teaching the Dharma that fully knows all three times. For these reasons, from the ten directions, all the tathāgatas, as many as the specks of dust in a fine particle of ten thousand buddha-fields, in complete accord in name, bless you in all these respects. Son of good family, drawing on the ten settings of the bodhisattva, by the power of the buddhas and the blessing of the buddhas, give rise to eloquent confidence in teaching this Dharma.

Then those buddhas, blessed ones, bestowed upon the bodhisattva Dharmamati the radiance of unobstructed wisdom; freedom from obscuration;

freedom from interruption; the nature of reality that is never forgotten; undifferentiated wisdom; freedom from fault; that which cannot be overpowered; freedom from timidity; the nature of reality that cannot be stolen away; and the accomplishment of excellent speech. Why was this?

This was because they had attained the very nature of reality of this samādhi.

Then those buddhas, blessed ones, stretched out their right hands and stroked the head of the bodhisattva Dharmamati. As soon as those buddhas, blessed ones, touched the bodhisattva Dharmamati, he rose from that samādhi and spoke to those bodhisattvas.

"O sons of the Victor, this is the family of the bodhisattvas: it is as vast as the realm of phenomena is pervasive, and as the limit of the realm of space is far-reaching. O sons of the Victor, in this way, the bodhisattvas, the great beings, are born into the family of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past. They are born into the family of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the future. They are born into the family of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the present."

Then those bodhisattvas said this to the bodhisattva Dharmamati: "O son of the Victor, who are those bodhisattvas, those great beings, who are born into the family of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present? With what in mind do you say this? O son of the Victor, please tell us what those ten settings of the bodhisattva are, the settings of the bodhisattvas."

When they had said this, the bodhisattva Dharmamati spoke to those bodhisattvas as follows: "O sons of the Victor, the settings of the bodhisattva, of the bodhisattvas, are these ten. They were taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past and the future, and of the present. They are taught, they were taught, and they will be taught. What are the ten? They are these: the setting of the bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought of awakening; the beginner; the one engaged in yoga; the one who has taken birth; the one perfect in application; the one perfect in intention; the one who cannot turn back; the one who has become a youth; the heir to the throne; and the setting of the bodhisattva who has received consecration. O sons of the Victor, these are the ten settings of the bodhisattva, of the bodhisattvas. They were taught by the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past and the future, and of the present. They are taught, they were taught, and they will be taught."

"O sons of the Victor, what is the setting of the bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought of awakening? O sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought of awakening, as soon as he sees the buddhas, the blessed ones, sees a beautiful form, or a handsome one, or one of flourishing and radiant complexion, or one that is vast, or one of great splendor; or sees a miraculous display of magical power, or a miraculous display of discourse, or a miraculous display of instruction; or sees suffering beings; or hears the Tathāgata's praises extensively recounted, then, desiring the wisdom of omniscience, he generates the thought of unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening from the very first. As soon as he has generated that thought, he takes hold of the ten difficult-to-approach grounds of understanding. What are the ten? They are these: knowing what is possible and what is impossible; knowing the actions and the undertakings of phenomena, past, future, and present; knowing the paths that lead everywhere; knowing the many and varied elements; knowing the many kinds of inclinations and liberations; and..."

knowing the superior and inferior faculties; knowing the meditative concentrations, the liberations, the absorptions, and the attainments, with all their defilement, purification, and emergence; the knowledge that recollects former abodes; the knowledge of the divine eye; and knowing the exhaustion of defilements. He takes hold of these ten difficult-to-approach grounds of understanding.

Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought.

Sons of the Victor, that bodhisattva, that great being who has just generated the first thought, should be applied to honoring the buddhas and to the comforts and requisites of a bodhisattva. It should also be said of him that he becomes a lord of the world, a supreme one, one who cannot be overpowered; that he meets countless buddhas; that he practices the meditative absorption of perfect peace; that he turns back the wheel of saṃsāra; that he sets in motion the wheel of the sacred Dharma; and that he protects suffering beings. Why is this so? Because from the very moment the thought is generated, he is for the most part joined to all the qualities of a buddha, and he applies himself even to those grounds above, of which he has heard, having gained the ability not to leave the matter to the shoulders of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the bodhisattva who has just generated the first thought.

Sons of the Victor, what then is the account of the beginner bodhisattva? Sons of the Victor, the beginner bodhisattva first generates ten kinds of thought toward sentient beings. What are the ten? They are these: the thought of benefiting, the thought of bringing happiness, the thought of compassion, the thought of tenderness, the thought of affection, the thought of helping, the thought of protecting in every way, the thought of equanimity, the thought of a teacher, and the thought of a guide. He generates these ten kinds of thought. Sons of the Victor, this is the beginner bodhisattva.

Sons of the Victor, that beginner bodhisattva should apply himself to receiving the scriptural transmissions and to reciting them from memory. Having heard much, he should apply himself to complete solitude. Having become secluded, he should apply himself to delighting in spiritual friends. Delighting in spiritual friends, he should apply himself to being easy to instruct. Having become easy to instruct, he should apply himself to knowing the right time. Knowing the right time, he should apply himself to fearlessness. Having become fearless, he should apply himself to knowing the meaning. Knowing the meaning, he should apply himself to following the Dharma. Following the Dharma, he should apply himself to the nature of phenomena without forgetfulness. Having become free of bewilderment, he should apply himself to the analysis of phenomena. Why is this so? Because from the very moment the thought is generated, he for the most part strives earnestly toward all the qualities of a buddha, and he applies himself even to those grounds above that are to be attained, having gained the ability not to leave the matter to the shoulders of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the beginner bodhisattva.

Sons of the Victor, what then is the account of the bodhisattva who practices yoga? Sons of the Victor, the bodhisattva who practices yoga realizes phenomena through ten kinds of focus. What are the ten? They are these: he realizes all phenomena as impermanent; all phenomena as suffering; as without self; as empty; as without movement;

without breathing; without abiding; without conceptual thought; without effort; and without deliberate formation. Because he has come to follow the Dharma, he does not strive, and yet he does not fail to strive either. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who practices yoga.

Sons of the Victor, that bodhisattva who practices yoga should apply himself to examining the realm of sentient beings. He should apply himself to examining the dharmadhātu. He should apply himself to examining the realms of the

world. He should apply himself to examining the earth element. He should apply himself to examining the water element, the fire element, the wind element, the space element, the form realm, and the formless realm.

Why is this so? Because he for the most part enters into the appearance of phenomena, and because, even regarding those grounds above that he has heard about, he applies himself directly and has gained the ability not to leave the matter to the shoulders of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the bodhisattva who practices yoga.

Sons of the Victor, what then is the account of the bodhisattva who is born by rebirth? Sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who is born by rebirth is born into the noble lineage through ten purifying practices. What are the ten? They are these: irreversibility from the nature of reality; the complete accomplishment of unshakable faith in the buddhas that reaches its culmination; certainty in contemplating the Dharma; discernment concerning sentient beings; discernment concerning buddha fields; discernment concerning the world; discernment concerning karma; discernment concerning karmic maturation; discernment concerning saṃsāra; and discernment concerning nirvāṇa. Through these ten purifying practices he is born into the noble lineage. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who is born by rebirth.

Sons of the Victor, that bodhisattva who is born by rebirth should apply himself to discerning the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the past. He should apply himself to discerning the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the future. He should apply himself to discerning the equality of the qualities of the buddhas of the present. He should apply himself to discerning the equality of the qualities of all the buddhas.

He should apply himself to discerning the genuine accomplishment of the qualities of the buddhas of the past. He should apply himself to discerning the genuine accomplishment of the qualities of the buddhas of the future. He should apply himself to discerning the genuine accomplishment of the qualities of the buddhas of the present. He should apply himself to discerning the genuine accomplishment of the qualities of all the buddhas.

He should apply himself to discerning the equality in the complete perfection of the qualities of the buddhas of the past. He should apply himself to discerning the equality in the complete perfection of the qualities of the buddhas of the future. He should apply himself to discerning the equality in the complete perfection of the qualities of the buddhas of the present. He

should apply himself to discerning the equality in the complete perfection of the qualities of all the buddhas.

Why is this so? Because he for the most part realizes the equality of the three times, and because, even regarding those grounds above that he has heard about, he applies himself directly and has gained the ability not to leave the matter to the shoulders of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the bodhisattva who is born by rebirth.

Sons of the Victor, what then is the account of the bodhisattva who has perfected application?

Sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who has perfected application undertakes whatever virtuous deeds he begins for the sake of fully protecting all sentient beings; of wishing benefit for all sentient beings; of joining all sentient beings with happiness; of having compassion for all sentient beings; of liberating all sentient beings completely; of making all sentient beings free from harm; of guiding all sentient beings rightly; of inspiring faith in all sentient beings; of taming all sentient beings; and of leading all sentient beings fully beyond sorrow into nirvāṇa. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who has perfected application.

Sons of the Victor, for that bodhisattva who has perfected application, ten abodes should be properly expounded. What are the ten? They are these: that sentient beings are limitless, that sentient beings are immeasurable, that sentient beings are innumerable, that sentient beings are inconceivable, that sentient beings are incomparable, that sentient beings are beyond measure, that sentient beings are empty, that sentient beings are unmoving, that sentient beings are nonexistent, and that sentient beings are without intrinsic nature.

Why is this so? Because he for the most part rests his mind in the absence of fixation, and, even regarding those grounds above that he has heard about, he applies himself directly and has gained the ability not to leave the matter to the shoulders of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the account of the bodhisattva who has perfected application.

Sons of the Victor, what then is the account of the bodhisattva who has perfected intention?

Sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who has perfected intention is one who, upon hearing ten things, has a settled intention toward the qualities of

the buddhas. What are the ten? They are these. Whether one speaks in praise of the buddhas or speaks not in praise, his intention toward the qualities of the buddhas remains settled. Whether one speaks in praise of the Dharma or not in praise of it, whether one speaks in praise of the bodhisattvas or not in praise of them, whether one speaks in praise of the conduct of bodhisattvas or not in praise of it, his intention toward the qualities of the buddhas remains settled. Whether one says that the realm of sentient beings is small or says that the realm of sentient beings is vast; whether one says that the realm of sentient beings is wholly afflicted or says that it is not wholly afflicted; whether one says that the realm of sentient beings is easy to tame or says that it is difficult to tame; whether one says that the dharmadhātu is small or says that the dharmadhātu is vast; whether one says that the world systems are destroyed or say that they are not destroyed; whether one says that the dharmadhātu exists or says that the dharmadhātu does not exist, his intention toward the qualities of the buddhas remains settled. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who has perfected intention.

Sons of the Victor, for that bodhisattva who has perfected intention, ten ways of following the Dharma should be properly expounded. What are the ten? They are these: it should be properly expounded that all phenomena are without signs; that all phenomena are without defining characteristics; that they are without real entity; that they are nonexistent; that they are false; that they are secluded; that they are without essential nature; that they are like an illusion; that they are like a dream; and that they are without conceptual thought. Why is this so?

This is so because, being unable to be robbed of this, he becomes one whose nature is, for the most part, to increase his superior intention; and even regarding those matters he has heard of above, he applies himself directly and has gained the state of not resting on the tracks of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the presentation of the bodhisattva who has perfected intention.

Sons of the Victor, what is the presentation of the bodhisattva who does not turn back? Sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who does not turn back is one who, on hearing ten objects of focus, does not turn back from the qualities of the buddhas. What are the ten? They are these. Even on hearing that there is a buddha or that there is no buddha, he does not turn back from the qualities of the buddhas. Likewise, on hearing that there is Dharma or that there is none; that there are bodhisattvas or that there are none; that there is the conduct of bodhisattvas or that there is none; that a bodhisattva will

emerge definitively through the conduct of bodhisattvas or will not emerge definitively; that the Tathāgatas have passed away or have not passed away; that the Tathāgatas have come or have not come; that the Tathāgatas have now appeared or have not now appeared; that the wisdom of the buddhas is exhaustible or inexhaustible; and that the three times have one defining characteristic or do not have one defining characteristic. Even on hearing these, he does not turn back from the qualities of the buddhas. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who does not turn back.

Sons of the Victor, for that bodhisattva who does not turn back, ten streams of Dharma should be properly expounded. What are the ten? They are these: it should be properly expounded that all phenomena are one and also that they are different; that they are many and also one; that meaning is superimposed upon letters; that letters are superimposed upon meaning; that nonentities are superimposed by means of entities; that entities are superimposed by means of nonentities; that the signless is superimposed by means of signs; that signs are superimposed by means of the signless; that the characteristicless is superimposed by means of characteristics; and that characteristics are superimposed by means of the characteristicless. Why is this so? Because, being for the most part skilled in all phenomena, he emerges definitively in the manner of full maturation, and even regarding those matters he has heard of above, he applies himself directly and has gained the state of not resting on the tracks of others. Sons of the Victor, this is the presentation of the bodhisattva who does not turn back.

Sons of the Victor, what is the presentation of the bodhisattva who has become a prince? Sons of the Victor, here the bodhisattva who has become a prince is endowed with ten realizations of the Dharma. What are the ten? They are these. He is endowed with the fact that bodily actions have results. He is endowed with the fact that verbal actions have results. He is endowed with the fact that mental actions have results. By the mere generation of the mind he accomplishes birth as he wishes. He knows the intentions of other sentient beings and other individuals, and discerns their inclinations. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the elements of sentient beings. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the desire realm. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the form realm. He thoroughly knows the diversity of the formless realm. And because he proceeds in accord with the times, his higher knowledge is swift. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who has become a prince.

Sons of the Victor, for that bodhisattva who has become a prince, ten ways of accomplishing the Dharma should be properly expounded. What are the ten? They are these:

Thorough knowledge of the buddha-fields; the shaking of the buddha-fields; the blessing of the buddha-fields; the discernment of the buddha-fields; going to the buddha-fields; going to innumerable world-systems; asking innumerable questions; the accomplishing of the mind-made body; the application of immeasurable skill in languages; and the perfect accomplishment of innumerable buddha-fields through the generation of the awakening mind: these should be properly expounded. Why is this so? Because for the most part he applies himself to accomplishing what is acquired through skill, and, in the case of those stages of which he has heard above, he has attained the capacity to practice them himself without leaving them to others. Sons of the Victor, this is the classification of the bodhisattva who has become a prince.

Sons of the Victor, what is the classification of the bodhisattva who is a crown prince, the heir? Sons of the Victor, the bodhisattva who is a crown prince is skilled in ten things to be realized. What are the ten? They are these: he is skilled in realizing the births of sentient beings; skilled in realizing the movements of the afflictions; skilled in realizing the connections of habitual tendencies; skilled in realizing the application to fields of activity; skilled in realizing the nature of reality; skilled in realizing close engagement; skilled in realizing the distinctions among world-systems; skilled in realizing knowledge of the past limit, the future limit, and what arises in the present; and skilled in realizing the definitive understanding of conventional truth. Sons of the Victor, this is the bodhisattva who is a crown prince.

Sons of the Victor, ten stations should be properly expounded for that bodhisattva who is a crown prince. What are the ten? They are these: skill in the retinue of the royal palace should be properly expounded; and likewise the full engagement with the retinue of the royal palace; entering the retinue of the royal palace; discerning within the retinue of the royal palace; the consecration of the Dharma king; the blessing of the Dharma king; the overcoming of others by the Dharma king; the station of the Dharma king; and the command of the Dharma king. Why is this so? Because his mind, for the most part, enters into the accomplishing of unobstructedness regarding all phenomena, and, in the case of those stages of which he has heard above, he has attained the capacity to accomplish them himself without leaving them to others. Sons of the Victor, this is the classification of the bodhisattva who is a

crown prince.

Sons of the Victor, what is the classification of the bodhisattva who has received consecration? Sons of the Victor, the bodhisattva who has received consecration possesses ten accomplishments of knowledge. What are the ten? They are these: he frequently causes innumerable world-systems to shake; he frequently blesses innumerable world-systems; he frequently carries innumerable world-systems across in a single thought; he frequently purifies innumerable world-systems; he frequently makes innumerable sentient beings know in a single thought; he frequently beholds innumerable world-systems; he is skilled in examining, in a single thought, the mental conduct of innumerable sentient beings; he is skilled in comprehending, in a single thought, the faculties of innumerable sentient beings; and he is skilled in disciplining innumerable sentient beings.

And he is skilled in causing innumerable sentient beings to enter into the mind of omniscience.

O sons of the Victor, no bodhisattva below the stage of the crown prince can know the bodily actions of that bodhisattva who has received consecration. They cannot know his actions of speech. They cannot know his actions of mind. They cannot know his miraculous powers. They cannot know his surveying by miraculous power. They cannot know his surveying of the past, nor can they know what he intentionally sets in motion. They cannot know the workings of his intellect. They cannot know the range of his mind. They cannot know the sphere of his wisdom. O sons of the Victor, such is the bodhisattva who has received consecration.

O sons of the Victor, concerning that bodhisattva who has received consecration, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, proclaim ten dwellings. What are the ten? They are these: knowing the three times; knowing the qualities of the buddhas; knowing the inseparability of the dharmadhātu; the dharmadhātu being without limit or center; completely filling all world-systems; illuminating all world-systems; blessing all world-systems; fully knowing all sentient beings; directly knowing all phenomena; and proclaiming the boundless wisdom of the buddhas. Why so? Because for the most part his mind has entered into omniscience. O sons of the Victor, this is the establishing of the bodhisattva who has received consecration.

Hardly had the bodhisattva Dharma Intelligence finished expounding these ten establishings of bodhisattvas, the great beings, when, in that very moment,

through the power of the buddhas, in each of the ten directions, as many world-systems as there are particles of dust in ten thousand buddha-fields shook in six ways: they shook, shook greatly, shook all over and greatly; they trembled, trembled greatly, trembled all over and greatly; they heaved, heaved greatly, heaved all over and greatly; they roared, roared greatly, roared all over and greatly; they resounded, resounded greatly, resounded all over and greatly; they quaked, quaked greatly, quaked all over and greatly.

Through the power of the buddhas, and through the attainment of the nature of reality, a rain of clouds of divine flowers also fell. A rain of clouds of divine incense also fell. A rain of clouds of divine perfumes also fell. A rain of clouds of divine powders, a rain of clouds of divine garlands, a rain of clouds of divine robes, a rain of clouds of divine jewels, a rain of clouds of divine lotuses, a rain of clouds of divine necklaces, and a rain of clouds of divine ornaments also fell. Divine cymbals sounded, though no one struck them. Divine radiance also appeared, and divine voices rang out.

Just as in this world of the four continents, in the palace of the lord of the gods (Indra) on the summit of Mount Meru, so too in all world-systems this teaching of the Dharma pervaded and arose, without addition or deficiency. These very words show this very meaning.

Through the power of the buddhas, from beyond as many world-systems as there are particles of dust in ten thousand buddha-fields, bodhisattvas, as many as the particles of dust in ten thousand buddha-fields, came, filled the ten directions completely, and spoke thus: "O son of the Victor, excellent, excellent, that you thus teach this nature of the bodhisattvas!"

"O son of the Victor, we too are called by the name Dharma-Intelligence, and we have come here from the world-system called Cloud of Dharma, from the presence of the Tathāgata named Excellent Dharma-Intelligence. Through the blessing of the buddhas, this teaching of the Dharma arose in all those places, in assemblies just like this one, and with these very words it shows this very meaning, without addition or deficiency. O son of the Victor, we have come under your influence, and through the power of the buddhas we have come to this world-system. Just as we have come to this world-system, so too in all the four continents of all the world-systems of the ten directions, and in the palaces of the lord of the gods (Indra) on the summit of Mount Meru, bodhisattvas, as many as the finest particles of dust in ten buddha-fields, have come."

End of the first volume.

Second volume.

Then, through the power of the buddhas, the bodhisattva Dharma-Intelligence looked out over the ten directions, and over the entire assembly, and gazed upon the dharmadhātu as well. At that moment he spoke these verses:

Seeing one of self-arisen, utterly pure intelligence,
Beautiful, endowed with the power of a radiant form,
Adorned with marks hard to approach,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Seeing incomparable powers of miraculous display,
Excellent renown, and the teaching that follows,
And seeing beings of the world worn down by enduring suffering,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Having heard the qualities of Samantabhadra,
The Tathāgata, the source of all good qualities,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening,
Which is unchanging, like the expanse of space.

In order to realize all the bases that exist,
And the other bases that abide by their own nature,
As nothing other than the very things themselves,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the causes of all the virtuous
And non-virtuous actions that exist
In the past, the future, and the present times,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the stages of meditative absorption,
Concentration, liberations, and conduct,
And likewise the pure, final attainments of equipoise,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize, step by step, in each and every case,
The world's diligence, powers, and faculties,
Of whatever kind they may be,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the many treatises,
From the various inclinations of all the world
And the three kinds of differing superior intentions,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the nature of the elements,
Of every kind and every variety,
That exist in these three worlds,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the true nature of whatever
Goes everywhere within this Dharma,
And of whatever enters into virtuous practice,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to open fully the unattached eye
That sees how all the buddha-fields come to be,
And how beings arise from the grounds,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the classes of beings,
And whatever defining marks they have,
In past times and in the present,
And their former states,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to realize the exhaustion of the afflictions,
The fetters that bind beings in the world
As they wander through the destinies,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Whatever conventions are designated in the three worlds,
Whatever pathways of speech, modes of mantra, and conduct there may be,
In order to realize the truth of conventional designation,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

All phenomena are inexpressible,
Empty, unmoving, their very nature and essence;
In order to realize the ultimate truth,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In order to reveal the earth trembling in the buddha-fields,
And the oceans themselves thrown into turmoil,

And thus to show the miraculous powers of the Tathāgatas,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

From each single tip of a ray of light, rays of light
Spread out in the same way through all ten directions;
In order to realize that these are one light,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

However many buddha-fields there are, many and beyond thought,
In order to manifest them all in one's own hand,
And to realize that illusory manner of being,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

All the buddha-fields, and likewise all sentient beings,
Placing them without harm in the palm of the hand,
In order to realize that phenomena are without a life-force of their own,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

However much water there is in all the oceans,
One causes it to enter into a single drop on a hair-tip;
In order to realize the complete and final limit of all things,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Of all the atoms of fine dust within all the buddha-fields,
However many there may be, one counts them all without remainder;
In order to realize the number of the atoms,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In this world, the aeons that have passed,
And likewise those to come, fearful with the burning of the aeon;
In order to realize the exhaustion of the aeons,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

The Tathāgatas of the three times,
And the Teachers, the solitary buddhas, and those born from hearing;
In order to realize the nature of the Dharma,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

The inexpressible world-systems,
Bound up with a single hair, one places them all on the scale;
In order to realize the nature of things,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

The encircling mountain ranges, beyond thought,
Bound up with a single hair, one places them all on the scale;
In order to realize the coarse and the subtle,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In all the world-systems without exception,
In a single instant one makes oneself understood with one voice;
In order to show the pure aspects of that voice,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Whatever sounds there are in all the worlds,
In a single instant one speaks in an instant's speech;
In order to realize their nature of peace,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

One realizes all three worlds without exception,
Fully known by all sentient beings;
In order to realize the broad, vast tongue,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

In all the buddha-fields, just as it is spoken,
In a single instant one dispels wrong views;
In order to realize phenomena as conceptual constructs,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Here, in all the buddha-fields without exception,
In whatever field the Tathāgata is present, the self-arisen
Phenomena in a single instant, in order to realize them,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Like fine, separate particles, the world-systems
One manifests in every possible form;
In order to realize those that arise from the mind,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

The buddhas of the past, and likewise those yet to come,
However many dwell in the world, all of them,
In order to realize them in a single instant of mind,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Though one speak but a single phrase, beyond thought,
Even as the aeons are exhausted, it suffers no decline.

In order to realize the divisions of speech,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Whatever the destinies and whatever the reversals
Of all the worlds of the ten directions,
In order to realize them in a single instant of mind,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

Though one travels in every direction,
With body, speech, or mind one clings to nothing at all.
In order to realize the three times as empty,
One sets the steadfast mind upon awakening.

As the awakening mind is generated,
So one travels through the directions for countless aeons,
Making offerings in the presence of the buddhas.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

In the differing worlds of the ten directions,
Becoming a lord of the world, a child of the Victor,
One proclaims whatever is excellent and holy.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

While practicing in existence for the sake of awakening,
Whatever is the ease and union of the bodhisattva,
Of that one constantly speaks the praise.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

The supreme Dharma, the Dharma that is sublime and has gone beyond,
And whatever distinctive, noble, unsurpassed Dharma there is,
These one teaches to the bodhisattvas.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

The life of the Tathāgata, endowed with all qualities,
Exists in this very place and nowhere else;
In this the bodhisattva engages.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

How it is to meet the buddhas,
Immeasurable, countless, inconceivable,
This one shows to that bodhisattva.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

Whatever meditative absorptions there are, however many,
And likewise the varieties of the continuum of absorptions,
These one explains to the child of the Sugata.
This is the teaching of the irreversible ones.

Turning back the wheel of saṃsāra,
And setting in motion the wheel of the sacred Dharma,
Which no one in the world has ever turned before:
This is to be taught to the bodhisattvas.

For all the worlds in utmost suffering,
And for those harmed in the realms of the lower destinies,
One who becomes a refuge, a shelter, and an ally:
This is to be taught to the bodhisattvas.

One who sets the mind upon awakening
Is taught to be a bodhisattva of the first kind.
The instruction on the training, correctly determined,
And its proper arrangement, belong to such a one.

As in the teaching of those freed from sickness,
In order to benefit all the worlds,
Whoever first generates the mind in this way,
This one is the second kind, a beginner.

The mind that brings benefit, the mind of joy and ease,
The mind of kinship, of affection, and likewise the mind that gathers,
The mind of complete protection, the mind of equanimity,
The mind of the teacher, and the mind that teaches impartially:
For one who abides in minds such as these,
Study and recitation of the scriptures are to be joined.

Having heard much, let one be placed in the wilderness;
Having become secluded, let one be set to rely on spiritual friends;
Toward the spiritual friends let one be easy to instruct;
Let one know the proper time and be endowed with vigilance.
Knowing the time, let one become utterly fearless;
Being free from fear, let one strive for the meaning;
Having understood the meaning, let one speak the Dharma accordingly;
Let one be free from bewilderment about all phenomena.
Having become free of bewilderment, O child of the Victor,
Let one abide in the well-spoken Dharma.

This is the account of the beginner,
The bodhisattva who has entered upon awakening.
This is the instruction, this is the teaching;
Whoever trains in this is a child of the buddhas,
The third kind of bodhisattva.

Let one apply oneself fully to the teaching of the King of Dharma.
Impermanence, suffering, emptiness,
Selflessness, and the absence of any movement;
So too all these phenomena are not a self,
Without deliberate making, and utterly secluded;
All of this is free of conceptual thought.
In this way the bodhisattva reflects.

Concerning the realm of sentient beings and the basic space of phenomena as well,
He is inspired and praised, for the sake of examining them.
"The world-systems are boundless and without limit,"
Thus he sets his mind to investigate.
Here, as far as there is earth, water, and likewise fire,
Wind and space, and in every direction
The desire realm, the form realm, and the formless realm,
He sets himself to investigate all of these.

The vast phenomena in their entirety, and the elements,
Their intrinsic nature without remainder, to be examined to the very end:
This is taught, in due order, for the benefit
Of the buddhas' child who is engaged in practice.
The bodhisattva who is born into the lineage of awakening,
Born into the teaching, goes forth.
That wise one realizes things and the absence of things;
Born into the abode of the sacred Dharma, he is well born.
He never turns back from his own ground.
He is born with the conviction that buddhahood is the final goal,
And always has a mind certain about the Dharma.

He examines thoroughly what the nature of sentient beings is,
And karma, and worlds, and buddha-fields,
Karmic maturation, saṃsāra, and nirvāṇa.

The Victor's child knows the distinctions among them;
He is called the bodhisattva born in the heart.
Having examined all phenomena of the omniscient ones,
Past and present, and those yet to come as well,
Whatever has been accomplished, and whatever is well born, and the final
end,
And how the accomplishment of the self-arisen ones comes about,
He knows that all those holy buddhas
Have entered into the sameness of the three times.
They never set apart the particulars of that sameness;
They enter the three times without distinction.
One who has such benefits as these
Is the fourth kind of bodhisattva.

The bodhisattva who has well accomplished these
Will certainly go forth for the sake of awakening.
Thus the fifth kind of bodhisattva
Is described as one perfect in practice,
Following the way of skillful means,
Who brings to completion what he has undertaken through meritorious deeds.
Whatever merit he strives for in this way,
He becomes a support for the whole world,
Wishes to benefit, brings about happiness,
Is compassionate, and becomes a liberator of beings.
For the sake of taming a world gone to harm,
He leads and brings beings to serene faith.
Wishing to tame the many sentient beings, all of them,
With a mind that aims at nirvāṇa, his power is great.
He knows that all worlds are without end,
Likewise immeasurable and innumerable,
Incomparable, inconceivable, unequaled, and beyond measure,
And empty, unmoving, and without intrinsic nature.
This is the fifth kind of bodhisattva,
Endowed with perfect practice, benefit, and compassion.
For him the instruction is of this kind,
Taught by those who possess every quality.

He has no bewilderment about the endless sentient beings
Or about the essential nature of phenomena.
Exceedingly wise, free of thought, without conceptualization,
He is not set apart from the world with its gods.
Even if he hears praise or blame
Of the buddhas, the Dharma, the bodhisattvas, and their conduct,
Or that sentient beings are few or many,
His thought is not shaken.
Even if he hears that sentient beings are afflicted or pure,
Easy to tame or hard to tame,
That the basic space of phenomena is small or vast,
Will be destroyed or will be established,
That the basic space of phenomena exists or does not exist,
That bodhisattva who understands the three times
Reflects with certainty and examines everything,
And his intention is utterly settled in this buddha-Dharma.
Without sign, and without defining characteristic,
Things without essence, false in nature, and utterly secluded,
Of an illusory nature, like a mirage,
Such is the supreme, peaceful Dharma he is able to hear.
Thus the bodhisattva who does not turn back
Examines with certainty whether the buddhas, the Dharma, the bodhisattvas,
And their conduct exist or do not exist.
Whether they arise or do not arise, still he does not turn back.
Whether the Tathāgatas have passed away or have not passed away,
Whether they have not come, or are not "not come,"
Whether they have arisen or not arisen, are exhausted or are inexhaustible,
Whether suchness has one defining characteristic or none,
Whether it is one or different, of many aspects,
Whether the ultimate is the letters of speech, or is real, or is unreal,
All of this is a superimposition, or else something quite other than this;
The bodhisattva who does not turn back has faith in this.
Without sign, with sign,
Without defining characteristic, or marked by a mark,
Differentiated, or mutually combined:
Hearing these, he enters into this as the final goal.

The bodhisattva who has become a youth
Performs deeds that bear fruit by body, by speech, and likewise by mind,
And, just as he wishes, he displays his birth here.
He examines the intentions of others,
And acts in accord with their inclinations.
He knows the conduct of sentient beings, the Dharma that suits them,
The destruction and the formation of the realms.
As he wishes, he gives, and swiftly attains the superknowledges.
He directs his mind into all directions.
Though he hears the Dharma that praises the Sugata,
He does not become conceited about it.
He knows fully, and he shakes the realms;
Likewise he bestows blessing and engages in discernment.
Moving in an instant across countless realms,
He is to be described as going to the realms.
He answers countless questions in the same moment,
And displays bodies of every kind, even mind-made bodies.
In regard to this he voices boundless sounds, words, and phrases,
And in a single instant speaks of countless buddhas.

The bodhisattva who is the crown prince
Knows the entrance of sentient beings just as it is:
Their afflictions, their continuum, their habitual tendencies,
What their domain is, what their application is,
Their diverse dharmas, how they move,
The classification of worlds, the former limit,
The conventional truth and the ultimate truth;
He is skilled in realizing all of this without exception.
Skilled in the palace and its retinue, he brings forth the assembly.
There too, as to how he behaves in all ways,
The dwelling, and likewise how to enter,
And what the palace and its retinue are like when examined,
What the royal empowerment of the sacred Dharma is like,
What blessing and overcoming of others are like,
Entering the Dharma and proclaiming the transmitted word:
This is the crown prince's entry into the grounds.
With just this, his course reaches its end,
And as it has been taught, it becomes nothing other.

When at some time he lets go of the formations of life,
The crown prince, endowed with the proper way, turns directly toward the
Victor.

The one who is empowered is the sole son of the Sugata,
Exalted, supreme, a master who has reached the end.
He can take up the measure of water in the ocean on a single hair-tip.
Here his intention cannot be grasped by counting.
Such is the conduct of the Victor's sons.
Here, all the realms with their sentient beings and their deeds,
Ground into the finest dust, he can count completely.
Whatever is reckoned as "so many countless ones,"
All of that the bodhisattva knows here.

Buddhas of the past, likewise of the future,
And those who dwell in the ten directions,
Pratyekabuddhas and likewise śrāvakas:
The awakening mind, which is the seed of all these, arises.
When one first knows the awakening mind, whatever is said of it
Is countless in every way.
Were it to fill even all these world-realms,
What could be said beyond that?

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra spoke to the bodhisattva Dharmamati,
saying: Son of noble family, you have spoken well in expounding the dhāraṇī
of the Dkon mchog ta la la. Son of noble family, the qualities of the buddhas
are inconceivable. If those beings who merely hear the name of this teaching
draw near to omniscience, what need is there to speak of those who hold this
teaching, recite it, fully understand it, and practice it just as it is? Such beings
will surely become buddhas.

Dharmamati said: O son of the Victor, it is just so. It is exactly as you have
said. Those who possess profound wisdom should be known as having been
empowered by the Tathāgata.

Samantabhadra said: Son or daughter of noble family, whoever has such
teachings as these resound in their ears, those excellent persons should be
known as having received prophecy regarding the qualities of the buddhas. If
that is so, what need is there to speak of those who have this teaching in their
very hands?

Then the venerable Śāriputra bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said: Blessed One, please look upon me. Since I have not understood such teachings as these, I am like one who is blind. Blessed One, it is not only I who have become like one blind. Blessed One, all those beings who have not heard this teaching have become like the blind.

The Blessed One said: Elder, it is just so. It is exactly as you have said.

Śāriputra requested: Blessed One, please explain the inconceivable.

The Blessed One said: Śāriputra, go and urge Indra, Brahmā, and all the world protectors. Proclaim the command of the Tathāgata as well. Proclaim also to that assembly this dhāraṇī called the Dkon mchog ta la la, the supreme seal of the Dharma. Then the venerable Śāriputra, having heard the Tathāgata's command, went out of eagerness for the sake of the meaning of this dhāraṇī, and spoke of the matter to Indra, Brahmā, and the world protectors, saying: Come together, all who wish to listen to the Dharma. The Tathāgata will expound the dhāraṇī of the Dkon mchog ta la la and will also reveal the inconceivable. Assemble! Otherwise you will later regret it, saying: O friends, such precious sūtras are extremely rare to appear in the world.

Then in that very instant Indra, Brahmā, and all the world protectors gathered. They circumambulated the Blessed One three times, sat down before the Blessed One, joined their palms, and made their request to the Blessed One: Blessed One, please expound the dhāraṇī of the Dkon mchog ta la la.

Then the Blessed One remained silent, which was a sign of permission. Though Indra, Brahmā, and all the world protectors requested a second and a third time, the Blessed One still remained silent.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One: Blessed One, please expound the dhāraṇī called Dkon mchog ta la la. Sugata, please expound it. Then at that time the Blessed One extended the organ of his tongue from his mouth.

Sons of good family, all those who petition the Tathāgata for the sake of this dhāraṇī of the Dkon mchog ta la la will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. With these words he made his voice heard throughout the great world-system of a billion worlds. Then the Blessed One spoke again to the venerable Śāriputra, saying: Śāriputra, go and request the youth Mañjuśrī to teach the Dharma.

At that time Mañjuśrī, the youth, was sitting cross-legged and motionless beneath a flowering śāla tree, in a place apart. In a pavilion of great splendor, with a radiance surpassing hundreds of thousands of millions of suns, he sat encircled by Indra, Brahmā, and the world protectors, who gazed toward him. His body was the color of gold, and he shone blazing and brilliant with glory.

Then the venerable Śāriputra went to where the youth Mañjuśrī was, and on arriving he said to him: Son of good family, the Tathāgata requests you to teach the Dharma.

Then the youth Mañjuśrī said to the venerable Śāriputra: Venerable Śāriputra, what is the basis and meaning of this thing called the Tathāgata?

Śāriputra replied: Son of good family, your wisdom is profound. I cannot compete with you in analysis.

Mañjuśrī said: Then do not make yourself small in heart. Whatever you are able to bear, I will teach accordingly.

Śāriputra said: Son of good family, I will listen. Please speak.

Then the youth Mañjuśrī arose from that absorption and made his voice heard throughout the great world-system of a billion worlds. And at that time, all the sons of the gods dwelling in that world-system, from the class of the Pure Abodes down to Akaniṣṭha, came together. The four great kings, with their armies and attendants, also came together, along with many millions of yakṣas. Indra, Brahmā, and the world protectors also gathered. Both those who desired the Dharma and those who did not desire it also gathered. Many goddesses also gathered.

The assembly of monks, the assembly of nuns, the assembly of laymen, and the assembly of laywomen gathered. So too did the assemblies of the gods of the Thirty-Three, of Yāma, of Tuṣita, of those who delight in creation, and of those who wield power over the creations of others, the assembly of Brahmā's realm, and likewise the assemblies of gods up to Akaniṣṭha.

The company of hearers (śrāvakas) also gathered, namely: the venerable Subhūti, the venerable Mahākāśyapa, the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana, the venerable Śāriputra, the venerable Mahākātyāyana, the venerable Aniruddha, the venerable Gayākāśyapa, the venerable Mahākauṣṭhila, the venerable Cūḍapanthaka, the venerable Nadīkāśyapa, the venerable Uruvilvākāśyapa, the venerable Pūrṇa son of Maitrāyaṇī, the venerable Rāhula, the venerable Bhadrīka, the venerable Revata, the venerable Ānanda, and other great

hearers besides these, and five hundred nuns headed by Yaśodharā also gathered.

Kings of the realms and wheel-turning kings of power also gathered. Retinues of nobles, brahmins, and householders also gathered.

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra (Śāriputra) circumambulated the Blessed One three times and said: "Blessed One, by whose power has this great assembly gathered today? How should this be understood?"

The Blessed One declared: "Venerable Śāradvatīputra, this is through the power of the dhāraṇī of the Jewel Talala."

Śāradvatīputra said: "Blessed One, I wish to hear the dhāraṇī of the Jewel Talala."

The Blessed One declared: "Śāradvatīputra, go and make your request to Mañjuśrī, the youthful, and to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra."

Then the venerable Śāradvatīputra spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful: "Son of noble family, please teach this meditative absorption, the precious teaching, the Jewel Talala."

Mañjuśrī said: "Reverend Śāradvatīputra, who is it that will hear the dhāraṇī of the Jewel Talala?"

Śāradvatīputra replied: "These gathered four assemblies, and Indra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors who have assembled here. I too have come in order to listen."

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful, said to the elder Śāradvatīputra: "Elder Śāradvatīputra, if all these listeners to the Dharma are an illusory creation, then to whom am I to teach the Dharma? Who is the listener? Who is the speaker?"

The elder said: "Excellent being, you speak, and I will listen."

Mañjuśrī said: "Reverend Śāradvatīputra, this word 'teaching,' what is it a synonym for?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, 'teaching' is a synonym for emptiness."

Mañjuśrī said: "Śāradvatīputra, of what is emptiness a synonym?"

He replied: "Mañjuśrī, emptiness is wordless."

Mañjuśrī said: "Reverend Śāradvatīputra, if emptiness is wordless, what is there to teach? Reverend Śāradvatīputra, all phenomena are indemonstrable; they cannot be shown, and they cannot be heard."

The elder said: "Son of noble family, all that you have taught is a teaching of emptiness, a teaching of signlessness, a teaching of wishlessness, a teaching of nothing to be taken up, a teaching of nothing to be abandoned, a teaching of freedom from conceptual elaboration. It is a teaching of the unelaborated."

Then that whole assembly of bodhisattvas, together with Indra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors, rejoiced greatly, and with one voice they praised Mañjuśrī, the youthful, and the venerable Śāradvatīputra, saying, "Excellent! This dhāraṇī of the Jewel Talala has been well taught."

Then the venerable Subhūti spoke to Mañjuśrī, the youthful: "Mañjuśrī, how should a bodhisattva hold this dhāraṇī of the Jewel Talala? How should he recite it, fully awaken to its meaning, and explain it extensively and correctly to others?"

Mañjuśrī said: "Subhūti, this dhāraṇī should be contemplated as unarisen. It should be contemplated as without entities, without defining characteristics, without conceptual elaboration, and without anything to be abandoned."

As Mañjuśrī, the youthful, taught this exposition of the Dharma, ninety-two bodhisattvas in that assembly attained the meditative absorption called Heroic Progress. Sixty-two gods and humans attained the acceptance of the unarisen nature of phenomena.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, and with palms joined together,

he addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, what is the great compassion of bodhisattvas, the great beings?"

The Blessed One declared: "Noble son, the great compassion of bodhisattvas, the great beings, is this: not abandoning the three realms entirely. This is great compassion. Showing the buddha-fields to all sentient beings is great compassion. Embracing sentient beings of broken discipline is great compassion. Not forsaking the Perfection of Wisdom is great compassion. Giving up body and life for the sake of all sentient beings is great compassion. Speaking words of true loving-kindness to beings who are given to attachment is great compassion. And loving-kindness toward powerful beings is likewise the great compassion of bodhisattvas, the great beings.

"Noble son, furthermore, a bodhisattva, a great being, should cultivate a mind free of anger toward all sentient beings, and should practice at length being free of hostility."

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra addressed the Blessed One with these words: "For the sake of the healing and the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, for the benefit and healing and well-being of the great multitudes, of gods and humans, may the Blessed One please expound the dhāraṇī called Tala Tala, the Jewel. May the Blessed One, who holds healing and compassion for all sentient beings, expound it."

Then the Blessed One, in the voice of Brahmā, addressed those bodhisattvas with these words: "Among you, who is willing, in the later time, in the last five hundred years, when the true Dharma is vanishing, to teach this exposition of the Dharma correctly and thoroughly?"

Then the following bodhisattvas came forward: the bodhisattva Samantabhadra; the bodhisattva Mañjuśrī, the youthful; the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara; the bodhisattva Great Power Attained; the bodhisattva Abandoner of the Lower Realms; the bodhisattva King of Medicines; the bodhisattva Heaped Eloquence; the bodhisattva Sovereign Who Is Noble Through All Phenomena; the bodhisattva Inexhaustible Intelligence; the bodhisattva Ocean of Intelligence; the bodhisattva Radiant Jewel; the bodhisattva Jewel Light; the bodhisattva Jewel-Crested; the bodhisattva Beholder; the bodhisattva Unseen by Sight; the bodhisattva Ever-Beholding; the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi; the bodhisattva Jewel Heap; the bodhisattva Source of the Jewel; the bodhisattva Glory of Dharma; the bodhisattva Glory of the Crest; the bodhisattva Glory of Wealth; the bodhisattva Glory of Merit; the bodhisattva Glory of Sandalwood; the bodhisattva Intelligence of Dharma; the bodhisattva Nectar Intelligence; the bodhisattva Boundless Intelligence; the bodhisattva Adorned with Merit; the bodhisattva Adorned with Qualities; the bodhisattva Adorned with Marks; the bodhisattva Ever-Laughing, Delighting All the Faculties; the bodhisattva King Who Fells the Mountain Peaks; the bodhisattva Skilled in Eloquence; and the bodhisattva Ever-Outstretched Hand.

the bodhisattva Earth-Holder; the bodhisattva Swift Eloquence; the bodhisattva Essence of Space; the bodhisattva Essence of the Moon; the bodhisattva Essence of the Sun; the bodhisattva Essence of the Stainless Moon; the bodhisattva Essence of the Sun-Parasol; the bodhisattva King of

Superknowledge; the bodhisattva Great Mountain; the bodhisattva Steadfast Intelligence; the bodhisattva Courageous Eloquence; and the great bodhisattva Maitreya. These and other bodhisattvas, numbering sixty-two thousand hundred-thousand billions, spoke together with a single voice:

Blessed One, in the final age, in the last of the five hundred years, when the sacred Dharma is vanishing, all of us will gather and assemble, and we wish to rightly expound the dhāraṇī called Alala of the Jewel.

The Blessed One declared: Excellent, excellent, sons of good family! This is a difficult thing to do. A rite such as this is exceedingly difficult to perform.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: Son of good family, listen to the dhāraṇī of Alala of the Jewel, which benefits many beings and brings happiness to many beings.

Then the Blessed One, seated on the lion throne of great splendor, spoke the mantra:

Homage to all the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas. Tadyathā: Oṃ maṃ, bharate, bharate, bharabharanate svāhā.

Then the Blessed One uttered an inspired utterance two and three times: "Alala dharma! Alala dharma! Alala dharma!"

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said to the Blessed One: Blessed One, what is the meaning of the ground of this "dharma, dharma"?

The Blessed One declared: Son of good family, the meaning of the ground of all phenomena is the meaning of groundlessness. The meaning of the ground of all phenomena is the ground of the absence of intrinsic reality. The meaning of the ground of all phenomena is the ground of space. The meaning of the ground of all phenomena is the ground of there being nothing to take up. The meaning of the ground of all phenomena is the ground of there being nothing to discard.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked: Blessed One, then why are they called "all phenomena"?

The Blessed One declared: Son of good family, what is called "all phenomena" is the eye, the ear, the nose, the tongue, the body, and the mind; likewise the elements, the sense sources, and dependent origination. Son of good family, this is what is called "all phenomena." Furthermore, son of good family, all phenomena are empty because they have never been born from the

beginning.

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, said to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: O child of the Victors, how should this dhāraṇī of Alala of the Jewel be held?

When he had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Samantabhadra replied to Mañjuśrī: This dhāraṇī should be held as the teaching of suchness; as the suchness of non-arising; as the suchness of non-origination; as the suchness of the absence of defining characteristics; as the suchness of space; as the suchness of the absence of intrinsic reality; as the suchness of essential nature; and as the suchness of the essential nature that lacks intrinsic reality. Son of good family, this dhāraṇī of Alala of the Jewel is to be held, fully upheld, meditated upon, and thoroughly examined,

It is to be designated, established, explained, analyzed, and clarified in this way. Son of good family, this is the meaning of the meditation upon, and the thorough examination of, the dhāraṇī of Alala of the Jewel.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince: Mañjuśrī, how long is it since you entered fully into this Dharma teaching?

Mañjuśrī replied: Śāriputra, it is possible to say how long it is since attachment, aversion, and delusion entered it.

Śāriputra said: Son of good family, how long is it since attachment, aversion, and delusion entered it?

Mañjuśrī replied: Śāriputra, it is possible to say how long it is since the earth element entered it.

Śāriputra said: Son of good family, how long is it since the earth element entered it?

Mañjuśrī replied: Śāriputra, it is possible to say how long it is since knowledge and ignorance entered it.

Śāriputra said: Son of good family, how long is it since knowledge and ignorance entered it?

Mañjuśrī replied: Śāriputra, it is possible to say how long it is since the element of space entered it.

Śāriputra said: Mañjuśrī, how long is it since the element of space entered it?

Mañjuśrī replied: Śāriputra, it is possible to say how long it is since all phenomena, whose essential nature is the absence of real entities, entered it.

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince: What capacity do I have to converse with such superior beings? Son of good family, it is like this: even if all the dogs and cats, or all the foxes, gathered together, they could not demolish Meru, the king of mountains. In the same way, son of good family, even all hearers such as I cannot fathom the very edge of a single teaching of a bodhisattva, let alone the teaching of Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said to Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince: Mañjuśrī, go forth, and request the Tathāgata to grant his protection and full care to those Dharma teachers who, in the later time, in the later age, uphold this king of sūtras.

Then Mañjuśrī, the youthful prince, rose from his own Dharma seat and said to the Blessed One: Blessed One, please explain the special qualities of those Dharma teachers who uphold, read, and fully understand this Dharma teaching, and who also teach it extensively and correctly to others.

The Blessed One declared: Mañjuśrī, those monks who uphold this king of sūtras and speak the Dharma will certainly come to belong to my Dharma body. They will attain the awakening of a buddha. They will draw near to the qualities of the buddhas. Māra, and the sons of the gods belonging to Māra's retinue who watch for an opening, will find no opening against them.

Son of good family, those who give rise even for the span of a finger-snap to an unloving thought toward such a monk, a Dharma teacher, will become far removed even from rebirth as human beings, so what need is there to speak of the awakening of a buddha? Moreover, Mañjuśrī, those who give rise to a faithless thought toward monks who uphold this king of sūtras will have foul, uneven teeth. They will be without tongue or nose. Their hips and arms will be twisted backward. Their bodies will be afflicted by disease. They will be blind. They will be of confused and disordered discernment. They will be of weak diligence,

Mañjuśrī, these are the faults that befall such deluded people. In brief, Mañjuśrī, at the time of their death, in each and every pore of their bodies they will enter immeasurable sufferings of the beings in hell. Even if they are born as humans, they will always be blind, and they will be without a tongue.

Moreover, Mañjuśrī, those who reject this Dharma discourse will in this very life become lepers. Their mouths will look hideous and frightening. Their bodies will be withered, naked, and dried up. They will come to resemble

hungry ghosts (pretas). Moreover, Mañjuśrī, as for the places where those deluded people will be born, I know them through the inconceivable wisdom of a buddha.

Then Mañjuśrī, who had become a youth, made this request: "May the Blessed One make a prophecy. May the Sugata make a prophecy."

The Blessed One said: "Mañjuśrī, do not ask in that way, like a babbler. On hearing this, the world with its gods will become intoxicated, will become terrified, will tremble, and will tremble greatly."

Mañjuśrī said: "So that these beings, having heard such a thing, will never again reject the sacred Dharma, may the Blessed One, thinking with compassion, explain it."

The Blessed One said: "Mañjuśrī, beneath the earth there are hells for sentient beings, named as follows: Hot, Extremely Hot, Black Line, Totally Blazing, Intensely Blazing, Hard to Touch, Fierce, Sharp Beak, Iron Mortar, Iron Cauldron, Dark Pit, Head-Praising, Pillar-Fastening, Monkey-Faced, Ever-Blazing, Putrid, Ever-Stinking, Utterly Crushing, Thoroughly Crushing, and Utterly Harm-Crushing. Mañjuśrī, these are the hells of sentient beings in which those deluded people will be born."

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, when those who speak the Dharma die and pass from here, where will they be born?"

The Blessed One said: "Samantabhadra, it is excellent that you have asked this. Samantabhadra, when such a son or daughter of good family who speaks the Dharma dies and passes from here, he or she will be born in the buddha field, the world realm, called Adorned with Inconceivable Confidence, of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata. In that world realm there is a vast multitude of bodhisattvas who are altogether beautiful. At the time of death, one hundred and twenty million buddhas will appear before that son of good family. In brief, son of good family, the benefits of that son of good family are immeasurable and beyond reckoning. They could not be told even in thousands of eons."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said: "Blessed One, in the final time, in the final age, what kinds of beings will there be who will reject this Dharma discourse?"

The Blessed One said: "Samantabhadra, those beings who will reject such teachings as these will for the most part be renunciants, who will say: 'These

are poetic compositions. These were not spoken by the Tathāgata. These are fabrications of one's own devising. We have never before heard of these sūtras.' Saying this in their arrogance, they will reject this Dharma discourse. And having rejected it, they will not confess it or make amends for it,

Because they have rejected the Dharma, at the time of death those beings will be born in the hell called Blazing Everywhere, a place of unbearable torment. As soon as they are born, an iron wheel will cut off the heads of those deluded people, and their heads will fall to the ground. Even after this, for many eons, for many hundreds of thousands of eons, for many thousands of eons, they will be blind. And if, after hundreds of eons have passed, they should be born as humans, then in every lifetime they will be born blind. They will be tongueless, with faces turned backward, hunchbacked, with sunken necks and crippled legs, with voices like the barking of dogs. They will be constantly hungry and tormented by thirst, with withered bodies and mouths parched and numb, and they will be born so that all beings who see or hear of them find them repulsive.

Then the entire assembly spoke with one voice: "Blessed One, we confess our fault as a fault: we who have rejected such sūtras, and we who have looked with anger upon those who teach the Dharma. Blessed One, however childish we have been, however deluded, however confused in our discernment, however small-minded, we confess it all. May the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, be mindful of us."

Then those great hearers, together with Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the world-protectors, and the monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen, trembled, and said: "Blessed One, having heard such a teaching, we are utterly terrified."

The Blessed One said: "Friends, it is so. It is just as you say. It is fitting that you should be afraid. Friends, I have attained omniscient wisdom, and even I am afraid. How much more so should my disciples be! Sons of noble family, this Dharma is profound. Not even a human, a nonhuman, a god, a nāga, a yakṣa, or a gandharva is able to disturb it. How then could any other ascetic or brahmin possibly do so? Sons of noble family, this Dharma discourse has become a place of veneration for the world with its gods. Sons of noble family, just as one regards a jewel as a precious treasure, so too should one regard this king of sūtras."

Then the youthful Mañjuśrī said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this has been well spoken. But Blessed One, how will such monks fully digest the

offerings given in faith?"

The Blessed One said: "Mañjuśrī, those who reject this Dharma discourse and harbor an unloving mind toward those who teach the Dharma, I do not permit them to enjoy offerings given in faith for even a single day, or for even the time it takes to milk a cow. I do not permit them even to spit a single gob of spittle on ground that has been offered to the Saṅgha."

Then the venerable Śāriputra said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, are the five heinous crimes close to this, or are they far from it?"

The Blessed One said: "Elder Śāriputra, do not ask such a harsh question. Why? Śāriputra, the five heinous crimes are never like rejecting this supreme Dharma discourse. Śāriputra, one who commits the five heinous crimes will exhaust them quickly and will be born again as a human. But a person who rejects the sacred Dharma will never attain the qualities of a buddha. Such a person falls himself and also causes others to fall."

Then the venerable Śāriputra, in the presence of the Blessed One, said this: "Alas! Those beings who reject the sacred Dharma are in suffering. May I never even see in a dream such karmic obscurations as these."

Third section.

Then the Blessed One said this to the venerable Śāriputra: "Śāriputra, do not think that the Dharma I have taught is something that makes things come about. The world has karma as its owner; it lives on the share of its own karma; it rests upon its own karma. Beings experience the feelings of suffering through their own respective karma, and in that the Tathāgata has no part. Śāriputra, I have taught the path that leads to well-being: the path of going to happiness, going without fear, going to nirvāṇa, going to the deathless. And yet these beings are endowed with wrong conduct of body, wrong conduct of speech, and wrong conduct of mind. They slander the noble ones and hold wrong views. Through the karma of wrong views and through the cause of having rejected the true Dharma, when their bodies break apart and they die, they fall into the lower realms and wretched destinies and are born among the hell-beings. In that, the Tathāgata has no part.

Śāriputra, toward all beings such compassion arises in me that I think: for the sake of even a single being I would undergo the sufferings of the hells for an eon, or for more than an eon, but I would not abandon even one being. Śāriputra, such is the great compassion of the Tathāgata.

Śāriputra, it is like this. Suppose a man has an only son, handsome and beautiful, lovely to behold, of fine complexion, flourishing and endowed with the best qualities. If that son met with some misfortune and his time of death came, the man, thinking of his son, would be pained and unhappy, and would weep and utter lamentations. In just the same way, Śāriputra, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, regards suffering beings as an only son. Yet the Tathāgatas do not dwell together with the afflictions. Śāriputra, it is like this: the great ocean does not remain together with a corpse. In just the same way, Śāriputra, the Tathāgatas do not remain together with the afflictions.

Śāriputra, it is like this. Suppose a magician, or a skilled apprentice of a magician, conjures up a great crowd of people at a crossroads. Though they appear to perform various actions, those actions do not exist anywhere in the land and do not exist in any direction; they have not arisen, have not ceased, and will not cease. In just the same way, Śāriputra, the Tathāgatas bring beings to full maturity and even display the conduct of desire. Though they display such deeds, that conduct does not truly exist. Just as space is free of conceptual thought and free of elaboration, so too the body of the Tathāgata is free of conceptual thought and free of elaboration. Nevertheless, in accord with beings, the Tathāgatas act in accord, and in whatever way beings may be tamed, in that way the Tathāgatas engage in accord with them.

Śāriputra, the Tathāgata has no confusion. The Tathāgata has no ignorance. The Tathāgata has no forgetfulness. Śāriputra, I am the elder of the world with its gods, its chief, its foremost, its supreme, its most excellent,

the supreme, the unsurpassed, the unexcelled, the unequalled, and the equal of the unequalled.

Śāriputra, these words are in accord with the truth. Whether they be renunciants or householders, those beings who abandon this exposition of the Dharma will all come to experience such sufferings as those of the hell beings.

Then the venerable Subhūti, having heard this teaching of the Blessed One, joined his palms and said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, those beings have made a wretched gain. For those who come to abandon this exposition of the Dharma, what sort of tongue will they have?"

The Blessed One declared: "Subhūti, the tongues of those beings will become a hundred thousand leagues in length. Upon each of them, burning, blazing iron ploughs, blazing intensely, blazing and flaring up on every side, a single

mass of flame, will plough them five hundred million times. Why is that? Because they did not guard their speech. Subhūti, such is the karmic obscuration of those deluded people."

Then the whole assembly, by the power of the Buddha, joyfully exclaimed: "What the Tathāgata has taught is a great marvel!"

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, said to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I will carry those monks who teach the Dharma upon my shoulders. I will honor them with flowers, incense, perfumes, garlands, and unguents. Three times by day and three times by night I will bow to them. I will attend upon them and revere them. I will hold them in high regard. I will treat them as my teachers. I will adorn them with splendor. I will make offerings to them. I will serve them with respect. I will make requests of them. I will esteem them, regard them as my teachers, and guard them with reverence. Why is that? Because they are the sons of the Blessed One, born from the body of the Dharma.

"Blessed One, it is like this. A king's son of the warrior caste, anointed upon the crown of his head as heir, of fine form, handsome and pleasing to behold, is worthy of the offerings and homage of all those beneath him. In the same way, those who teach the Dharma are worthy of the offerings and homage of the world with its gods."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Noble son, Śakra, lord of the gods, has spoken these words well, in order to hold those Dharma-teaching monks dear, to nurture them, to protect them on every side, and to guard them."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said: "Blessed One, I too will protect on every side those sons or daughters of noble family. I will guard them well, I will uphold them, and I will bring them peace and well-being. I will keep watch over them all around, for a hundred leagues in every direction."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Noble son, you have spoken these words well. Excellent! Excellent!"

Then, in the voice of Brahmā, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

You who gather benefit and happiness for others,
Adorned with manifold splendor, your words supreme and fitting,
Your intention is supreme, utterly stainless in its beauty.
You have spoken well, in verses equal to the unequalled jewel of virtues.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra said to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, if bodhisattvas, great beings, possess how many qualities will they obtain the dhāraṇī of the Jewels, Tālala?" The Blessed One said: "Noble son, if bodhisattvas, great beings, possess one quality, they will obtain the dhāraṇī of the Jewels, Tālala. What is that one quality? It is this: being free of resentment toward all sentient beings.

"Samantabhadra, there are two further qualities of bodhisattvas, great beings. What are the two? They are these: being free of envy, and being free of arrogance. Samantabhadra, these are the two qualities of bodhisattvas, great beings.

"Samantabhadra, moreover, a bodhisattva, a great being, never becomes a source of harm to the faculties of any sentient being. Noble son, moreover, a bodhisattva should never, in any way whatsoever, give rise to the wish to harm any sentient beings."

When this account of the qualities of bodhisattvas was taught, and when the full account of the special qualities of the dhāraṇī of the Jewels, Tālala, was taught, immeasurable beings among gods and humans obtained the dhāraṇī.

This is the chapter on the full account of the special qualities of the dhāraṇī of the Jewels, Tālala.

Then the venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, and, bowing with palms joined toward the Blessed One, said to him: "Blessed One, this exposition of the Dharma is profound."

The Blessed One said: "So it is, Ānanda. Form is profound because it is profound. Feeling, perception, formations, and consciousness are profound because they are profound. Emptiness is profound because it is profound. Space is profound because it is profound."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, I have directly heard eighty-four thousand sections of the Dharma from the Tathāgata, yet I have never before heard an exposition of the Dharma like this one." The Blessed One said: "This exposition of the Dharma is extremely difficult to hear."

Ānanda said: "In the last time, in the last of the five hundred years, when the true Dharma is vanishing, may the Blessed One bless this exposition of the Dharma, so that it may perform the work of the buddhas for many sentient beings."

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, I have already blessed this exposition of the Dharma. I, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, have also blessed those who speak this Dharma. Ānanda, whoever writes down this exposition of the Dharma will not suffer illness of the eyes, nor of the tongue, nor of the nose, nor of the teeth. They will not suffer illness of the hands or feet, nor of the head, nor of the ears. Their body will not become wretched, and their body will not become foul-smelling. They will not meet an untimely death through the harm of others. All humans and non-humans will protect them. When they die and pass from here, having wholly abandoned all conceptual elaboration, they will be born among the gods in a happy destiny, in the higher realms."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, what is the cause and what is the condition by which Māra does not create obstacles when this Dharma is taught?" The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, no Māra is able to obstruct this exposition of the Dharma."

"Ānanda, when the wicked Māra conceives the thought, 'I will go and create obstacles to the teaching of the dhāraṇī of the Jewel-Supreme Ala-la,' at that very moment the wicked Māra sees his own home everywhere ablaze. Ānanda, this exposition of the Dharma is that profound. Ānanda, any place where this exposition of the Dharma is practiced will become a shrine, and it will also become worthy of homage."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, suppose this exposition of the Dharma also abides in the very place where the Tathāgata dwells, and I come to see the Tathāgata. Having come, if I first pay homage to the Tathāgata and afterward pay homage to this exposition of the Dharma, what fault would there be in that?"

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, if you were to set aside an exposition of the Dharma such as this and pay homage to me, then you would be at fault. Furthermore, Ānanda, although I am the eldest, the chief, the foremost, and the most excellent in the world with its gods, it was only because I first heard this exposition of the Dharma that I afterward became fully and perfectly awakened to awakening."

Ānanda said: "Blessed One, from whom did the Tathāgata hear this teaching of the precious meditative absorption, the Jewel-Supreme Ala-la? Who is there above the Tathāgata?"

The Blessed One said: "Ānanda, in the world of humans, in the world of gods, and in the world of gandharvas, there is no one above me. Nevertheless, when

I was practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva, I heard it directly from the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Unobstructed Wisdom, Heap of Essences, Excellent Light, whose center expands with many inconceivable rays of light. Ānanda, after enduring great hardships for many millions of hundreds of thousands of ages, I heard this exposition of the Dharma. At that time that Tathāgata gave me the prophecy. Therefore, Ānanda, first pay homage to this exposition of the Dharma, and afterward pay homage to me."

Then Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the world-protectors all said together in one voice these words: "Ala-la, the Dharma! Ala-la, the Dharma! The magical display of phenomena is Ala-la! Those beings who merely hear the name of this exposition of the Dharma are worthy of homage. How much more so, then, those who uphold it, recite it, fully realize it, and extensively and rightly teach it to others! Such beings should be called Tathāgatas."

Then the Blessed One said to Śakra, Brahmā, and the world-protectors: "Friends, you have spoken these words well. Excellent! Excellent!"

Then the Blessed One extended the organ of his tongue from his mouth, and having illuminated the world-system of the great trichiliocosm with the organ of his tongue, he spoke these words to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Those beings who do not hear this exposition of the Dharma are like a blind man who cannot see the light of the sun, like a merchant who does not know the proper means, and like a poor man who looks to the faces of others for help.

"If for their sake I give this example, then in order that beings may not be kept far from a heap of precious Dharma such as this, I now make this request of you for the sake of this exposition of the Dharma and for the sake of all beings: son of good lineage, are you willing?"

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, and bowed toward the Blessed One with palms joined, weeping. And the very moment the bodhisattva Samantabhadra rose from his own Dharma seat, this world-system of the great trichiliocosm shook in six ways: it shook, shook greatly, shook all over. It trembled, trembled greatly, trembled all over. It quaked, quaked greatly, quaked all over. It resounded, resounded greatly, resounded all over. It rumbled, rumbled greatly, rumbled all over. It was convulsed, convulsed greatly, convulsed all over. And a great light appeared in the world.

Then the bodhisattva Samantabhadra, joining his ten fingers in homage and weeping, spoke these words to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I am willing. Sugata, I am willing. Blessed One, you are omniscient, you wish only the benefit of all beings, and you are endowed with great compassion. Moreover, I am one born from the Tathāgata. Why then should I not act in accord with the Tathāgata's word? Blessed One, the Tathāgata's word is a word of nectar. How could I possibly have the power to act against the Tathāgata's word? Blessed One, I will make amends for what I have done; I will not fail to make amends."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Excellent! Son of the Victor, excellent, excellent! Among the sons of the Tathāgatas you are the eldest, the foremost, the supreme, the holiest, the most excellent. I entrust this exposition of the Dharma wholly to you. This is my Teacher, and therefore you must guard it. From time to time, air it in the sun. Keep it in a precious vessel and carry it upon your shoulder. In the later time, in the later age, do not trust those sinful monks. Son of good lineage, this is my instruction to you."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra asked: "Blessed One, what kind of renunciants will appear?"

The Blessed One said: "Son of good lineage, do not ask that, you crow."

The bodhisattva Samantabhadra said: "If it will bring healing to many beings, let the Blessed One please explain. Let the Sugata please explain."

The Blessed One said: "Samantabhadra, listen to what I will explain. Setting aside this ocean-like assembly, and Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, Īśvara, and all the innumerable, immeasurable bodhisattva mahāsattvas who keep this in mind, listen now to what kinds of renunciants will appear in the later time, in the later age."

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva Samantabhadra: "Samantabhadra, there will be renunciants who refute the sacred Dharma, who are attached to households, attached to gain, attached to monasteries, attached to dwellings, attached to alms bowls and Dharma robes, and who ruin households.

They will engage in all kinds of sinful actions. Samantabhadra, it is for the sake of those foolish people that I entrust this sūtra completely, lest this sūtra disappear."

Then from the ten directions all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and gandharvas gathered, and they spoke to the Blessed One in these words: "Blessed One, we too, all gathered and assembled together, will protect this Dharma discourse completely, for as long as we live and for as long as the sacred Dharma endures. We will also protect those monks who teach the Dharma. We will honor them, we will revere them, we will serve them, we will make offerings to them, we will provide them with gain, and we will make requests of them."

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses to urge on the bodhisattva Samantabhadra and the nine hundred and twenty million other bodhisattvas.

Of the qualities of those who have reached the perfections,
Listen to me as I tell you all of those qualities.
Cast away pride, arrogance, and heedlessness,
And listen with a mind that is joyful and content.

Here in Magadha, beneath the king of trees at the place of awakening,
It is said that the self-arisen lion among men was seated.
He abided in the supreme liberation of meditative absorption,
Seated at the foot of that great king of trees.

Equal in number to the dust motes of the buddha fields of the ten directions,
Hosts of supreme beings surrounded that hero.
The meditative absorption called the Buddha Avataṃsaka, the Great Garland,
In that absorption the Lord of Men abided.

When the Lord of Men had understood and entered that equipoise,
The youth Mañjuśrī, from the eastern direction,
Together with ten buddha fields' worth of dust motes in number,
Came to the Victor's presence with those supreme beings.

In the same way, from the buddha fields of all ten directions,
All the buddha-sons named Śrī came,
Together with a number of dust motes equal to the fields of the ten directions,
And arrived accompanied by those supreme beings.

When they had assembled there, the excellent being Bhadraśrī,
Out of the wish to benefit the world, questioned
Mañjuśrī, whose fame is boundless and whose qualities are endless:
"What is the conduct of the Buddha's sons, and what are their qualities?"

Then the bodhisattva called Mañjuśrī,
Free of turbidity, endowed with the qualities of awakening,

Whose range of activity is pure, vast in bliss and rich in qualities,
Was questioned by the excellent being Bhadraśrī:
"Pure is the range of conduct of the Buddha's sons.
What the Victors have relied upon, I will speak of here.
You too, speak of the qualities and conduct
Of the Buddha's sons, whatever they may be."

Bhadraśrī said: "Son of the Victor, listen.
Of those qualities, endless and abundant,
I will speak only a small example.
It is as small as a drop from the ocean.

When the self-arisen mind that is the ground of awakening
Is first generated,
The praise of its qualities is endless;
Even the Peerless One cannot express it fully.

As for the qualities of the perfections and the grounds,
Not to mention what is practiced over many eons,
Even all the Victors of the ten directions
Could not exhaust the stream of those qualities.

Of those endless qualities,
I will give only a slight example:
It is as small as a bird's trail in the sky,
Or equal to one speck of dust from the great earth.

The arising of the mind that is the abode of the qualities of awakening
Is not without cause and is not without condition.
Having generated faith and confidence
In the Victor, the Victor's Dharma, and the Saṅgha, the mind arises.

It does not arise for the sake of desire, enjoyment, or kingship,
Nor for one's own happiness, praise, or fame.
It is in order to pacify entirely the suffering of beings
That the mind that benefits the world arises."

Always, in order to benefit sentient beings,
To purify the buddha-fields and to make offerings to the buddhas,
To embrace the Dharma completely, and for the awakening of the buddhas,
And to purify primordial wisdom, that mind arises.

Toward all the Victors, toward the Dharma,
And likewise toward the noble assembly, always
Having awakened faith, clarity, devotion, and reverence,
That mind arises, in order to honor the spiritual teachers with respect.

Having faith in the Victor and in the Victor's Dharma,
And having faith in the conduct of the buddhas' children,
Having faith in unsurpassable awakening,
The mind of the great beings arises.

Those who have become lords of men through the power of faith
Make offerings with vast and immeasurable offerings,
And toward the Dharma and likewise the indivisible Saṅgha,
Having honored them with immeasurable offerings, the mind arises.

Faith gives birth to the mind like a mother who leads the way.
It guards and increases all qualities.
It dispels doubt and rescues from the floods.
Faith is the sign of the city of bliss.

Faith is free of turbidity and makes the mind clear.
It abandons pride and is the root of reverence.
Faith is a treasure, wealth, and the best of feet,
And like hands, it is the root for gathering virtue.

Faith makes one delight in complete giving.
Faith brings forth great joy in the Victor's Dharma.
Faith distinguishes qualities and wisdom.
It shows the state of buddhahood and brings its attainment.

It sharpens the faculties and makes them utterly clear.
Others cannot overcome the power of faith.
It is the ground for dispelling the afflictions.
Faith itself seeks out the spontaneous arising of qualities.

Faith is free of clinging at the gates of attachment.
It leaves behind the unfree states and is the one supreme freedom.
Faith carries one beyond the path of Māra
And reveals the supreme path to liberation.

Faith is the unspoiled seed in the field of qualities.
Faith brings forth the field of awakening.
It increases the distinctions of wisdom and qualities.

Faith reveals all the Victors.

Of those delightful distinctions of devotion born of faith,
The conduct that goes with them shall be told in due order.
Such a Dharma is exceedingly rare in the world,
Like the king of jewels in the midst of the ocean.

Those who always have faith and reverence for the buddhas
Never wholly abandon the training in moral discipline.
Those who do not abandon the training in moral discipline,
Endowed with qualities, are praised by those endowed with qualities.

Moral discipline reveals the awakening mind
And is linked to the qualities of the grounds of training.
Those who do not abandon the training in moral discipline
Become worthy of the Victors' praise.

Those who always have faith and reverence for the buddhas
Make vast offerings to the Victors.
Those who make great offerings to the Victors,
Their faith in the buddhas is beyond conception.

Those who always have faith and reverence for the Dharma
Are never sated with hearing the Dharma from the Victors.
Those who are never sated with hearing the Victors' Dharma,
Their devotion to the Dharma is beyond conception.

Those who always have faith and reverence for the Saṅgha
Have an unwavering faith in the Saṅgha.
Those who have deep and unwavering faith in the Saṅgha
Become unwavering through the power of faith.

Those who are unwavering through the power of faith
Have sharp faculties and are utterly clear.
Those whose faculties are sharp and utterly clear
Completely abandon bad companions.

Those who completely abandon bad companions
Are fully embraced by companions who possess the Dharma.
Those who are fully embraced by Dharma companions
Accomplish vast virtue.

Those who accomplish vast virtue,
Those great beings, possess the power of cause.
Those great beings who possess the power of cause
Come to have vast distinctions of devotion.

Those whose distinctions of devotion are vast
Are always blessed by all the Victors.

Those who are blessed by all the Victors
Also generate the mind for the sake of awakening.
Those who generate the mind for the sake of awakening
Strive after the qualities of the great sages.

Those who strive after the qualities of the great sages
Are born into the highest lineage, the lineage of the buddhas.
Those who are born into the highest lineage, the lineage of the buddhas,
Abandon both equal engagement and non-engagement.

Those who abandon equal engagement and non-engagement
Have faith and intention that are utterly pure.
Those whose faith and intention are utterly pure
Have the supreme and sacred superior intention.

Those who possess the supreme and sacred superior intention
Always practice the perfections.
Those who always practice the perfections
Enter this Great Vehicle.

Those who enter this Great Vehicle
Make offerings to the buddhas through their practice.
Those who make offerings to the buddhas through practice
Never part from the recollection of the buddhas.

Those who never part from the recollection of the buddhas
Always see the buddhas, beyond all reckoning.
Those who always see the buddhas beyond all reckoning
Are never without a buddha's presence.

Those who are never without a buddha's presence
Never fall away from the Dharma, even in between.
Those who never fall away from the Dharma, even in between,
Come to have unobstructed eloquence.

Those who have come to have unobstructed eloquence
Come to teach the Dharma without limit.
Those who teach the Dharma without limit
Have loving-kindness for beings and wish to benefit them.

Those who have loving-kindness for beings and wish to benefit them
Have a firmly established root of great compassion.
Those whose root of great compassion is firm
Become masters of joy in the Dharma.

Those who are masters of joy in the Dharma
Cast conditioned existence aside, seeing its faults.
Those who cast conditioned existence aside, seeing its faults,
Are free of pride and arrogance, and are not heedless.

Those who are free of pride and arrogance, and not heedless,
Are always diligent for the sake of themselves and others.
Those who are always diligent for the sake of themselves and others
Never become utterly weary of saṃsāra.

Those who are never utterly weary of saṃsāra
Possess supreme and sacred mindfulness.
Those who possess supreme and sacred mindfulness
Give rise to utterly pure higher knowledges.

Those in whom utterly pure higher knowledges arise
Understand the many kinds of conduct of beings.
Those who understand the many kinds of conduct of beings
Are skilled in fully ripening beings.

Those who are skilled in fully ripening beings
Know how to gather beings and are skilled in the proper methods.
Those who know how to gather beings and are skilled in the methods
Devote themselves to the four means of gathering disciples.

Those who devote themselves to the four means of gathering disciples
Work for the welfare of beings without limit.
Those who work for the welfare of beings without limit
Rely on wisdom together with skillful means.

Those who rely on wisdom together with skillful means,
Those heroes, abide on the unsurpassed path.
Those heroes who abide on the unsurpassed path

Cannot be overcome by the armies of Māra.

Those who cannot be overcome by the armies of Māra

Pass entirely beyond the path of Māra.

Those who pass entirely beyond the path of Māra

Attain the stage of irreversibility.

Those who attain the stage of irreversibility

Have won the acceptance of the unborn.

Those who have won the acceptance of the unborn

Are prophesied by the Victors as lamps of the world.

Those who are prophesied by the Victors as lamps of the world

Abide face to face with all the Victors.

Those who abide face to face with all the Victors

Are skilled in the secrets and magical displays of the Victors.

Those who are skilled in the secrets and magical displays of the Victors

Are held in mind by all the Victors.

Those who are held in mind by all the Victors

Are well adorned with all good qualities.

Those who are well adorned with all good qualities

Have also purified their bodies through sacred merit.

Those whose bodies are fully purified by supreme merit

Those who blaze like a mountain of gold,

Those who blaze like a mountain of gold

Are complete in the thirty-two major marks.

Those who are complete in the thirty-two major marks

Have bodies adorned with the excellent minor marks.

Those whose bodies are adorned with the excellent minor marks

Have a radiance of the body that is boundless.

Those whose bodily radiance is boundless

Have an array of light rays beyond imagining.

Those whose array of light is beyond imagining

Cause lotuses to arise from that light.

Those from whose light the lotuses arise

Reveal, in the forms of Victors seated upon lotus thrones,

Throughout the worlds of the ten directions,

And abiding in meaningful activity, they tame sentient beings.

Those who, in the forms of Victors seated upon lotus thrones,
Reveal themselves throughout the worlds of the ten directions,
And abiding in meaningful activity tame sentient beings,
Have boundless miraculous displays of higher knowledge.

Those whose miraculous displays of higher knowledge are boundless
Move about beyond all thought,
And teach the Dharma that is beyond thought,
And satisfy sentient beings beyond all thought.

Those who teach the Dharma beyond thought
And satisfy sentient beings beyond all thought
Tame the beings of the world, in accord with their dispositions,
Through the powers of the individual discriminating knowledges.

Those who, through the powers of the individual discriminating knowledges,
Tame the beings of the world in accord with their dispositions
Always have body, speech, and mind
Preceded and followed by wisdom.

Those whose body, speech, and mind are always
Preceded and followed by wisdom
Display, through the power of their aspirations, whatever forms are wished
Within the mind-streams of sentient beings.

Those who, through the power of their aspirations, display whatever forms are
wished
Within the mind-streams of sentient beings,
When they utter words,
Give rise to a sound with inconceivable branches of melody.

Those who, when they utter words,
Give rise to a sound with inconceivable branches of melody
Know, in a single instant, with their minds,
The minds of all beings without exception.

Those who know, in a single instant, with their minds,
The minds of all beings without exception
Never die and are never born,
And the movement of the afflictions does not arise in them.

Those who never die and are never born,
In whom the movement of the afflictions does not arise,
Have bodies of wisdom, the very nature of good qualities,
And by distinguishing the Dharma they move through the world.

Those whose bodies are wisdom, the very nature of good qualities,
And who move through the world by distinguishing the Dharma,
Abide in the ten grounds, the ten masteries,
The perfections, and the supreme liberations.

Those who abide in the ten grounds, the ten masteries,
The perfections, and the supreme liberations,
Attain in succession the empowerment, the array, the miraculous displays,
And abide in the supreme meditative absorptions.

Those who attain the empowerment, the array, the miraculous displays,
And abide in the supreme meditative absorptions,
Receive, from all the Victors of the ten directions,
All the empowerments without exception.

Those who receive from all the Victors of the ten directions
All the empowerments without exception
Are consecrated on the crown of the head by the buddhas of the ten directions
With palms filled with nectar.

Those who are consecrated on the crown of the head by the buddhas of the
ten directions
With palms filled with nectar,
Firm in power, like space itself,
Pervade all without exception and dwell in every direction.

Those firm in power, who like space itself
Pervade all without exception and dwell in every direction,
Those peerless ones, in their range of activity,
Cannot be fully known by the worlds with their gods.

Those peerless ones, whose range of activity
Cannot be known by the worlds with their gods,
For them, all that is seen, all that is heard of their name,
And their eloquence are all meaningful.

Those for whom all that is seen,

For those whose name when heard, and whose eloquence, are all meaningful,
For those great beings, every gift that a giver gives
Becomes meaningful.

Through the power of those holy beings,
The Dharma endures, and loving-kindness does not decline;
Virtuous actions come to flourish,
And the power of the Three Jewels becomes supreme and holy.

Where there is the supreme jewel, firm as a vajra,
By its power the jewels in the ocean
Do not diminish, do not decrease, and do not fail to increase.
So too, those whose waters of qualities are boundless,

In whatever field there is no buddha,
There they show the fully awakened buddhas' awakening.
In whatever directions there is not even the Dharma,
In those directions they reveal the treasury of the Dharma.

Free of thought, without conceptualizing,
Spontaneously accomplished, in all directions
They appear like the moon, and so reveal themselves,
And with a thousand skillful means they tame sentient beings.

In a single instant, in all the worlds
Of the ten directions, they show awakening and buddhahood.
Those heroes show the turning of the wheel, the passing into nirvāṇa and
peace,
And the spreading of relics far and wide.

Those wise ones, through the grounds of the hearers and solitary buddhas,
Show, for inconceivable aeons, the buddhas' arrays
And their boundless magical emanations,
And through the three vehicles they tame sentient beings.

Knowing the aspirations and the means of accomplishment of all,
They show themselves as boys and girls, as women's bodies,
As gods, humans, asuras, nāgas, and yakṣas,
And as the forms of kumbhāṇḍas and great pot-bellied beings.

Through the door of the samādhi called the ocean seal,
Those heroes show, without exception,
However many forms, behaviors,

Signs, conducts, and entries of speech the beings of the world possess.

Through their inconceivable arrays of buddha-fields,
They make offerings to all the Victors of the ten directions.

Those who, through inconceivable arrays of fields,
Make offerings to all the Victors of the ten directions,

Have inconceivable arrays of light rays,
And boundless wisdom that liberates sentient beings.
Those whose arrays of light rays are inconceivable,
And whose wisdom that liberates sentient beings is inconceivable,

Have inconceivable magical displays of body and speech,
And inconceivable magical displays of mind.
Those whose magical displays of body and speech
And of mind are beyond conception,

Have inconceivable magical displays of generosity and moral discipline,
Of patience and diligence.
Those whose magical displays of generosity and moral discipline,
Of patience and diligence, are beyond conception,

Through the samādhi of the great Buddha-assembly,
Have inconceivable magical displays of meditative concentration and wisdom,
Of skillful means and of the higher knowledges.
The magical displays of all qualities are boundless.

They enter the samādhi of the finest atom;
They bring about accomplishment in every atom,
And on a single atom there are inconceivable fields.
Though they show this, the atom does not grow larger.

On that atom they show some fields with buddhas
And some fields without any buddha;
Some fields free of afflictions and pure, others defiled,
And some fields vast, some subtle, and some great.

Some fields they show as being destroyed and as being formed,
Some as standing upside down, some as arranged in orderly array,
Some like a mist or a shimmering haze,
Some like a magical illusion.

Just as they show it on a single atom,
So they show it on all atoms without exception.
Such is the magical display of the samādhi of the seers;
Such is the liberation of the one of boundless renown.

Those, through the samādhi of magical displays of offering to the Victors,
Bring about accomplishment for all the Victors,
And fill the palm of the hand with the thousandfold trichiliocosm,

They make offerings to the great beings.
From the palms of their hands they bring forth, to honor the Victors seated
beneath the tree of awakening,
Whatever garlands of flowers and precious perfumed unguents there are in
the ten directions.

Whatever garments and powders and jewels there are,
Banners, pennants, and many kinds of supreme parasols,
And precious clusters adorned with gold,
All these they rain down from the palms of their hands.
Whatever boundless offering-materials there are in the ten directions
That are worthy to be offered to the great seers,
All these they rain down from the palms of their hands,
Making offerings to the Victors seated beneath the tree of awakening.

Whatever music there is in all the directions,
Drums and cymbals, sweet-sounding lutes,
Gentle bells, great resounding sounds, and flutes,
All these they sound forth from the palms of their hands.
The many kinds of praise of the true qualities
Of all the peerless ones throughout the ten directions,
And the many kinds of verses of eulogy and accomplishment,
All these they proclaim from the palms of their hands.

From the right hand they scatter abroad
The rays of light in which joy is fully gathered,
And pour perfumed waters down upon all the fields of the Victors,
Making offerings to the lamps of the world.
Beautiful light, adorned with arrays of rays,
Garlands of lotus ornaments hanging down in measureless profusion,
Many lotuses of excellent form and radiant hue,
These they offer from their hands to the Victors.
A great multitude of flowers, clusters of flowers,

And spreading rays of light arrayed with flowers,
Strewing flowers of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of incense, clusters of incense,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with incense,
Strewing incense of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of perfumes, clusters of perfume,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with perfume,
Strewing perfumes of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of garlands, clusters of garlands,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with garlands,
Strewing garlands of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of powders, clusters of powder,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with powders,
Strewing powders of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of robes, clusters of robes,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with robes,
Strewing robes of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of parasols, clusters of parasols,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with parasols,
Strewing parasols of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of jewels, clusters of jewels,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with jewels,
Strewing jewels of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of lotuses, clusters of lotuses,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with lotuses,
Strewing lotuses of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
A great multitude of ornamental garlands, clusters of ornamental garlands,
And spreading rays of light arrayed with ornamental garlands,

Strewing ornamental garlands of every kind in all directions,
Those great beings make offerings to the Victors.
Supreme victory banners, arrayed and spreading rays of light,
Banners of white, red, yellow,
And blue, and victory banners of many varied arrangements,
With many of these they adorn the fields of the Victors.
Parasols arrayed with many kinds of jewel-like adornments,
Silken streamers and pennants hanging down,
Nets of small bells and tinkling bells that sound the speech of the Victors,
These they hold over the heads of the Tathāgatas.
Just as these boundless offerings from the palms of their hands
Are made to a single Victor,
So likewise they are made to all the Victors without exception.

Such is the magical display of the samādhi of the sages.

Through the wisdom that gathers beings, they accomplish magical emanations and the supreme samādhis. Through every door of activity and of honoring others, through a thousand means, they tame sentient beings.

Some tame through the door of making offerings to the Tathāgatas, through the door of giving that is beyond thought, through the doors of the qualities of ascetic purification and of every kind of moral discipline, and through the doors of patience that is inexhaustible and unshakable.

Some tame through the doors of austere vows, hardship, and diligence, through meditative concentration and the door of perfect peaceful abiding, through the doors of wisdom that ascertains the meaning in every aspect, through the doors of skillful means that embrace every kind of conduct, through the brahmavihāras and the door of the higher knowledges, through the door of benefiting others by the means of gathering disciples, through the doors of accumulating merit and of wisdom, through truth, reliance, and the door of liberation.

Some tame through the doors of the powers, the faculties, and the path, through the door of liberation by the vehicle of the hearers, through the door of purification by the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas, and through the door of the magical display of the supreme vehicle.

Some tame through the doors of impermanence and suffering; some through the doors of selflessness and the absence of a life-force; through the door of

the perception of the unpleasant and freedom from attachment; and through the door of the samādhi of peace and cessation.

However many doors of conduct beings have, they enter just as many doors of Dharma. Through all those doors of liberation, they tame the beings of the world according to their dispositions. Those who, through all the doors of liberation, deliberately tame the beings of the world, cannot be grasped by anyone as a fixed characteristic. Such is the magical display of samādhi.

Now there is the supreme samādhi called the Array of Joy, which brings all beings to full maturation. Filled with joy, happiness, delight, and great gladness, they become steadfast in intention and tame sentient beings.

Wherever there is famine, and the world's necessities, everything that brings happiness, have become exceedingly scarce, there they act with deliberate intent for all. They give gifts and accomplish the aims of beings. By completely giving away the best food and drink and the finest flavors, clothing and garments, precious things of many kinds, kingdoms, wealth, and even their own cherished possessions, they tame beings who delight in giving.

Those steadfast ones adorn their bodies with the supreme marks, wear garments and the finest ornaments, are decked with garlands and anointed with perfumes. By displaying such forms, they tame sentient beings, for those who delight and are satisfied at the sight.

Those supreme in intellect reveal forms that are supreme and beautiful, the most excellent of forms, and so tame sentient beings who delight in form.

With the sweet voice of the kalapiṅka bird, and the cry of the cuckoo and the swan, with the sounds of drums, of Brahmā, and of the kiṁnaras, they teach the Dharma as it is to all who are inclined to hear.

Through the eighty-four thousand gateways of Dharma, which are the great sweep of the Victors' work for beings, they tame the beings of the world according to their dispositions.

They also become companions in happiness and in suffering, companions in what is beneficial and in what is harmful. They become companions in every undertaking, and through companionship they tame sentient beings. For the sake of their companions they endure suffering, harm, and the faults of conditioned existence. For the benefit and happiness of all beings, they accept harm for the sake of their companions.

Where no buddha appears and there is no Dharma, where one goes to the wilderness and no liberation is perceived, there they wholly renounce kingship and wealth, and with a mind at peace they appear in a place of no abode.

Those... home, bondage, and the realms of existence.

In order to free all beings, they dwell in none of the pleasures of desire. They go forth and teach liberation well. Explaining those ten practices, they proclaim the Dharma-conduct of the great beings and the entire conduct of the seers, and they accomplish the aims of beings.

Wherever there are boundless beings who live long, are happy, and have few afflictions, there they show beings oppressed by old age, afflicted by sickness and children, without power over themselves, fallen under the power of death. Where desire blazes and aversion blazes fiercely, where the world is ablaze with the great fire of delusion, and blazes with old age, sickness, and death, having shown such a world, they tame sentient beings.

By means of the ten powers of a buddha, the four fearlessnesses, and the eighteen distinctive qualities, they declare the greatness of the buddha's nature. Through the buddha's qualities they work for the good of beings. Teaching all of this, and demonstrating miraculous power, through the force of the blessing of the form body they display the miraculous power of the Tathāgata everywhere, and by miraculous transformations they tame sentient beings.

By many kinds of skillful means they move through the world and accomplish the aims of beings. Like a lotus unstained by water, unattached to the world, they move among beings, bringing joy and inspiring faith. They become panegyrists, bards, and composers of praise; dancers, drummers, acrobats, and musicians; they dance adorned with garlands and ornaments; as masters of illusion they display many forms everywhere. They become villagers and village headmen, ministers of state, likewise caravan leaders, merchant chiefs, and householders. They become kings and ministers, escorts and envoys, physicians, and experts in worldly treatises and rites. In the wilderness they become great trees, medicines, inexhaustible treasures of jewels, wish-fulfilling gems, and trees that grant desires. For those who have lost their way and wander in pits, they become guides who show the road.

Soon after they have appeared in the world, they come to know, and those who do not understand the ways of karma among beings, to all of them they teach farming, trade, the dharma of commerce, and the various crafts, and

they converse with the world about these things. Whatever practice is harmless and without injury, which the wise praise as bringing happiness to beings, the arts of strength and lineage, medicine, and the many treatises, all these those seers declare.

Whatever supreme and holy conduct of the seers the world with its gods reveres, and all the foremost austerities, vows, and hardships, those wise ones proclaim these too. They go among all the wandering non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), those who practice the way of Gautama, the way of silence; to naked, unclothed ascetics who devote themselves to such ways, they appear as skilled teachers of the tīrthikas. To all those who uphold a livelihood by their teaching, those with a superior or with none, those with long matted hair and young ascetic vows, to these too they become teachers. To the followers of the sun, those with the five austerities, those who practice the vows of dogs, cows, and deer, those with the Naked Ones and the thirty tīrthika sects, to these too they become teachers.

To those who delight in entering the knowledge of the gods, who wander in lands near the tīrthikas, who live on roots, fruits, and water, they appear as supreme in the Dharma of inconceivable meditations. To those who sit in a squatting posture, who wander alone, who lie on thorns, grass, and ashes, and who dwell on pestles and beds of wood, to these too they become teachers. For all the outer tīrthikas, as many as there are, they discern their dispositions and inclinations, and by fierce and unbearable austerity, hard to follow, they tame them, leading the tīrthikas to abandon suffering.

Knowing that the world is troubled by wrong views, for the tīrthikas who abide in bad views he shows the truth through a subtle foundation and by skillful means. To some he teaches the truth through the foundation of the mantras of those who move through the sky, through a most secret foundation. To some he speaks in clear and direct words; to some in the secret words of the gods; to some in words that distinguish the letters; to some in the words of vajra-like definitive meaning; to some in words that know how to tame opponents; to some in treatises, in words of irrefutable liberation. To some he speaks in the languages of humans, in words of entry open to all and in etymological explanations. To some he speaks in the words and etymologies of the gods, in the etymologies of the nāgas and the yakṣas. To some he speaks in the words of rākṣasas, spirits, and flesh-eaters, of gandharvas, kumbhāṇḍas, and great-bellied serpents, of kinnaras, asuras, and garuḍas. By these he teaches the truth and leads beings to liberation. Knowing the truth and the way of

etymologies, he thus teaches, through his knowledge of the inconceivable pathways of speech, the nature of all the Victor's teachings without remainder. Such is the magical display of their meditative absorption.

Here ends the fourth volume, the last.

Their meditative absorption is the supreme joy of beings. It accomplishes manifest benefit for all beings, and it sends forth rays of light, inconceivable and vast. Having sent forth the rays, it tames sentient beings. Whoever sends forth the rays of "Good to See," and whoever, among sentient beings, knows those rays, their seeing is not without meaning, for it is the cause of the supreme, unsurpassed wisdom. To all humans one fully shows the buddha and fully shows the Dharma, and by making images of the Victor's body and showing stūpas, the rays of "Good to See" come to be accomplished.

One sends forth the rays called "Light-Maker," which outshine the light of the gods and dispel all dust and darkness. The world is brightly illumined by that light which benefits it. Those sentient beings who are inspired by that light take up lamps to honor the Victors. By holding lamps to honor the Victors, they become Victors who make lamps for the world. Having offered to the Victors lamps of grain, butter, ghee, grass and wood, torches and shining lamps, incense, essences, and jeweled lamps, they obtain the Light-Maker.

One sends forth the rays called "Deliverer." Those sentient beings who are inspired by that light put on armor for the sake of delivering beings from the broad ocean of craving and existence. Those who put on armor for the sake of delivering beings from the broad ocean of craving and existence are themselves fully delivered from the four rivers, and they show the city of happiness without sorrow. By building many bridges and causeways, and launching boats to ferry people across rivers and roads, and by praising peace and rejecting the conditioned, the rays of "Deliverer" come to be accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that quench thirst. Those sentient beings who are inspired by that light fully abandon the thirst for the qualities of desire and seek as their goal the taste of delight in the Dharma. Having fully abandoned that thirst, and having come to seek the taste of delight in the Dharma, they become buddhas who rain down the nectar of immortality and completely dispel the world's thirst of craving. They dig ponds, rivers, wells, and springs, and make lakes for the sake of awakening, and by disparaging desire and praising meditative concentration, the dispelling of craving comes to be

accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that bring joy. Those sentient beings who are inspired by that light, with joy increasing, generate the mind, resolving, "For the sake of supreme awakening may I become self-arisen." They make images of compassionate bodies adorned with the major marks, seated upon lotus thrones, and by constantly speaking of the buddhas' qualities,

Thus the ray that brings delight comes to be accomplished. One sends forth the rays that bring contentment, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light are always delighted and content with the Buddha, delighted and content with the Dharma, delighted and content with the Saṅgha. Always delighted in the Buddha, and delighted in the Dharma and the Saṅgha, they come to keep constant company with the buddhas, the Dharma, and the noble assemblies, and they attain unsurpassed patience. Urging many beings, and bringing to their minds the recollection of the Buddha, the supreme Dharma, and the Saṅgha, and proclaiming the qualities of the awakening mind, thus the ray that brings contentment comes to be accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of accumulated merit, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light, seeking unsurpassed awakening, give many varied gifts. When they make offerings without stinginess, they fulfill the wishes of those who ask, and by giving whatever is wished for, the ray of accumulated merit comes to be accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that possess wisdom, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light, from the gateway of a single teaching, grasp in an instant the many gateways of the Dharma. They encourage beings to hold the distinctions of the Dharma, they unfold the wisdom that is certain about meaning, and they expound the words and meanings of the Dharma. Thus the ray that possesses wisdom is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of the lamp of discernment, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light enter into the teaching that is empty, selfless, unborn, unarisen, and without intrinsic nature. They teach that phenomena have no master, are empty and without agent, like an illusion, a mirage, the moon in water, like a dream, like a reflection. Through such teaching the lamp of discernment is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of the Dharma's wondrous display, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light attain the dhāraṇī of inexhaustible patience and uphold the treasury of all the Tathāgatas. They

benefit the holders of the Dharma, protect the sages through the Dharma, and, by guarding beings with the Dharma, the ray of the Dharma's wondrous display comes to be accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that possess generosity, and those sentient beings who are stricken with poverty, inspired by it, come to know that wealth is impermanent and unstable, and they come to delight always in giving. Beings who are untamed, hard to tame, and miserly, knowing riches to be like a dream or a cloud, expand their giving with joyful minds. Thus the ray endowed with generosity is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that are free of remorse, and those sentient beings of broken discipline who are inspired by it come to abide in utterly pure moral discipline and generate the mind, resolving, "May I become self-arisen." They purify the paths of virtuous action, lead many beings into moral discipline, and cause them to hold the awakening mind rightly. Thus the ray free of remorse is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of the array of patience, and those impatient sentient beings who are inspired by it abandon anger, contempt, and pride, and come always to delight in patience. They bear with the faults of the wicked, and are not disturbed, for the sake of awakening, and by constantly praising the qualities of patience, the array of patience is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that possess ascetic discipline, and those lazy sentient beings who are inspired by it become diligent in the Three Jewels, making offerings with tireless effort. Having made offerings to the Three Jewels with tireless effort, they pass utterly beyond the paths of the four mārās and swiftly touch unsurpassed awakening.

Having caused many sentient beings to take up diligence, and having made offerings to the Three Jewels, they uphold the sacred Dharma in the time of its decline. Through this one obtains the light that possesses ascetic discipline.

One sends forth the rays that bring peace, and those sentient beings who are disturbed and agitated, when inspired by them, become free of attachment, free of anger, free of delusion. Having come to realization, they become possessed of a mind in meditative equipoise. Having utterly abandoned evil companions and those of faulty conduct, and having praised the peaceful meditative concentration of the wilderness, one accomplishes the light that brings peace.

One sends forth the rays that array wisdom, and those sentient beings of confused understanding, as many as are inspired by them, come to comprehend the truths, steadfastness, the modes of liberation, and the knowledge of the faculties. Having comprehended these, they attain the meditative absorption called the Lamp of the Sun, and become a Victor who makes wisdom shine. Having wholly given up kingdom, wealth, and possessions, and having sought the Dharma for the sake of awakening, one reveres that Dharma and teaches it well. Thus the light that arrays wisdom is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that possess buddhas, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light see many thousands of inconceivable buddhas seated upon sacred lotuses. By telling of the greatness of the buddhas, the liberation of the buddhas, and the boundless emanations of the buddhas, and by proclaiming the powers and miraculous abilities of the buddhas, one accomplishes the light that possesses buddhas.

One sends forth the rays that bestow fearlessness, and those sentient beings in danger and terror who are touched by them are freed from all fears: from spirits, from baleful planets, from killing, beating, and bondage, and from plague and epidemic. Whoever has protected sentient beings by giving fearlessness, has turned others back from taking life, and has given refuge to those who seek refuge from fear, by that the light that bestows fearlessness is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that bring all happiness, and those who are sick and ill, when touched by them, are freed in every way from the suffering of illness, and also attain the joys of meditative concentration and absorption. One obtains this by healing the sick, and by giving the fruits of medicine, roots, precious restorative elixirs, incense and ointments, molasses, honey, milk and butter, grains, oil, food, and drink.

One sends forth the rays that show the Buddha, and those who, at the very end of their lives, are inspired by them come to recollect the Buddha and to see the Buddha. When these ones pass from this life, they go to where the buddhas dwell. One obtains this light by recollecting the Buddha at the time of death, by showing the joy-giving image of the Victor, and by declaring, at the moment of death, one's going for refuge to the Buddha.

One sends forth the rays that proclaim the Dharma, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light listen to the Dharma, read it, and ask for it in

writing. They come always to delight in the Dharma and to have devotion to it. In times of Dharma famine, one teaches the Dharma, fulfills the aspirations of those who seek the Dharma, arouses enthusiasm, and understands the Dharma through diligence. Through such teaching one obtains the light that proclaims the Dharma.

In order to inspire all the sons of the Buddha, one sends forth the rays endowed with melody, and whatever strains of sound there are in the three worlds, all are heard as the voice of the Tathāgata. One praises the great sages with secret hymns of praise, and for the sake of the meaning of the Victor's words, one offers cymbals and sweet music, great drums and bells, proclaiming them to all beings. Through this the light endowed with melody is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that bestow the deathless, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light wholly abandon all heedless conduct and devote themselves to practicing all good qualities. Conditioned things are never a source of happiness; they are completely filled with the many torments of suffering.

By proclaiming that cessation is ever blissful, peaceful, and secure, one obtains the gift of the deathless.

One sends forth the rays of distinction, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light come to know the distinction of the Victors' moral discipline, the distinction of their meditative absorption, and the distinction of their wisdom and learning. Because one praises and extols, for the sake of awakening, the Great Sage, the king of the Dharma, as supreme in discipline, supreme in absorption, and supreme in wisdom, the light of distinction is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of arrayed jewels, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light obtain inexhaustible treasures of jewels. They honor the great seer with the finest jewels. They offer jewels to the Victors and to the Victors' stūpas, though people are gathered in by the jewels of the afflictions. Because one has offered jewels to the Victors, the rays of arrayed jewels are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of radiant fragrance, and those sentient beings who are inspired by that light come to sense a delightful fragrance, such as does not exist among humans, and they become certain of the qualities of the buddhas. With the incense and perfumed unguents of humans and gods they

make fine offerings to the chief of men. Because one has made images of the Victor and stūpas from fragrant substances, that radiant fragrance is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of varied adornment: banners, pennants, and many kinds of supreme parasols, the sound of cymbals resounding, and fragrant incense burning. They beautify the sublime palaces and scatter flowers. With cymbals they welcome the Victors, and they honor them with flower garlands, incense, powders, banners, pennants, and supreme parasols. Thus the varied adornment is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays of great serenity, and the grounds are made as level as the palm of a hand. Because one has cleansed the stūpas and the dwellings of the seers, the light of great serenity is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays endowed with clouds, and clouds raining fragrance abide everywhere. Because one has sprinkled the surroundings of stūpas with fragrant water, the light endowed with clouds is fully obtained.

One sends forth the rays of flowing garments, and the naked come to be clothed and adorned. Because one has given clothing, robes, and many kinds of ornaments and garlands, the flowing garments are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays endowed with supreme flavor, and the hungry come to obtain food of supreme flavor. Because one has given food, drink, and many kinds of supreme flavors, the light endowed with supreme flavor is accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that reveal wealth, and the poor obtain treasuries of jewels. Because one has presented to the Three Jewels an inexhaustible store of treasure, the light that reveals wealth is obtained.

One sends forth the rays that purify the eyes, and then the blind see forms of many kinds. Because one has offered lamps to the Victors and to the Victors' stūpas, the rays that purify the eyes are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify the ears, and those whose hearing was impaired come to hear many sounds. Because one has offered cymbals to the Victors and to the Victors' stūpas, the rays that purify the ears are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify the nose, and those who never smelled before come to perceive sweet fragrance. Because one has offered fine incense to the Victors and to the Victors' stūpas, the rays that purify the nose

are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify the tongue, and with pleasing and melodious sounds they praise the buddhas. Having abandoned unpleasant and harsh speech, one speaks gently, and thus the rays that purify the tongue are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify the body, and those whose faculties were impaired come to have sound faculties. Because one has prostrated one's body to the Victors and to the Victors' stūpas, the purification of the body is obtained.

One sends forth the rays that purify the mind, and all who are mad regain their minds. Because one has led the mind through the power of samādhi, the rays that purify the mind are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify form, and the lords of men behold the bodies of the buddhas, beyond all thought. Through the many and varied painted images of the Buddha's body, and through adorning stūpas, the rays that purify form are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify sound, and sound is fully known as not empty of sound. Because one has taught that sounds arise from conditions and are like an echo, the rays that purify sound are accomplished.

One sends forth the rays that purify smell, and every foul odor becomes a supreme fragrance. These are the rays of the awakened buddha-field for one who has bathed the Victors' stūpas with the finest perfumed water.

One sends forth the rays that purify taste, and what is poisonous becomes poison-free and a supreme flavor. These are the rays of one who has offered every supreme flavor to the buddhas together with the hearers, and to one's father and mother.

One sends forth the rays that purify touch, and what is rough to the touch becomes soft and pleasant. Showers of short spears, three-pointed lances, swords, and great arrows turn into soft garlands, lotuses, and blue lotuses. These are the rays of one who has spread out soft and pleasant-to-touch cloths of many kinds as a path for the Victors to walk upon, and who has offered flowers, ointments, soft garments, and garlands and crowns.

One sends forth the rays that purify phenomena, and from every pore of all the Victors who benefit the world, inconceivable teachings of the Dharma are heard, and all who have faith are satisfied. Whatever arises from conditions is

unborn in its very nature; the body of the Victors is the Dharma body; the nature of reality, like space, abides always. By speaking thus, one comes to attain the purification of phenomena.

These and the other gateways of rays: from a single pore of the sages there arise rays as many as the sands of the Ganges, and all of them differ according to the way their actions were performed. Just as from one pore there arise rays as many as the sands of the Ganges, so it is from all the pores without exception. Such is the magical display of the sages' samādhi.

By whatever qualities each ray is accomplished, and by whatever companions that quality previously had, from those very things the rays arise. Such is the magical display of the sages' wisdom.

Those who were former companions in that merit, those who rejoiced and offered prayers, and those who saw and accumulated virtue: all of these know those rays. Those who have made merit and gathered virtue, who again and again make offerings to the buddhas, who long for the qualities of the buddhas and seek their meaning: to all of these those rays give encouragement.

For example, though the blind do not see the sun, it is not that it does not exist; it shines upon the world. When those with eyes know that it has risen, they all go about their own respective tasks. In the same way, though all the rays of the great beings fully arise, they are obstructed by wrong views, and those of ordinary, declined faith do not see them. Yet for those of broad understanding they are there.

Or again, ornaments, jewels, mounts, palaces, nourishing elixirs, precious ointments, and incense exist for the great and prosperous, but for the destitute they do not exist. In the same way, the rays of the great beings exist, yet they are obstructed by wrong views, and those whose faith has declined do not see them. But for those of broad understanding they are there.

Those who, having heard this explanation of the rays, have faith, devotion, and clear confidence, and who do not give rise to doubt or hesitation, wondering whether they themselves will come to have great qualities: those will not give rise to doubt or hesitation.

Through their attendants, their retinues, and their arrayed emanations, they accomplish the supreme absorption, and in all ten directions they reveal the sons of the Buddhas with the long, graceful bodies of the Incomparable Ones.

Those arrays of light bring forth lotuses of many kinds
extending to the measure of a thousand million worlds, which they bless;
with bodies seated in the crossed-leg posture they reveal themselves
everywhere.

Such are the wondrous transformations of this absorption.

Further lotuses, as numerous as the dust motes of ten buddha-fields,
together with their retinues, they bless;
and the sons of the Buddhas completely surround them all.
Those beings abide in absorption without any absorption.

Those sages have brought to full maturity whatever beings there are
and have well accomplished buddhahood;
these beings encircle that great lotus,
and all sit gazing with palms joined.

This is the nature of those great beings
who have entered and abide in absorption:
they are completely surrounded by their own disciples,
as the moon is surrounded by a host of stars.

Just as these enter into one direction
and the sons of the Buddhas, the intermediate ones, make their display there,
so they reveal themselves in all directions without exception.
Such are the wondrous transformations of this absorption.

They remain pervading the whole net of the directions,
actually accomplishing the supreme absorption;
some are in equipoise while others rise from it,
and in all ten directions they display their own bodies.

While they are in equipoise in the eastern direction,
the hero rises from it in the western direction;
while the great being is in equipoise in the western direction,
he rises from it in the eastern direction.

In just this way he enters all ten directions;
while in equipoise in one direction,
he rises from it in another, rich in the qualities of wisdom.
Such are the wondrous transformations of the sage's absorption.

Whatever buddha-fields there are in the eastern direction,
countless and without exception, each self-arisen,

in the presence of those buddhas, at their feet,
he is seen abiding in peaceful absorption.
Having shown himself in equipoise in that direction,
the hero rises from it in all the fields of the west,
and is seen making manifold offerings
to all the Victors in their very presence.

Whatever buddha-fields there are in the western direction,
countless and without exception, with buddhas dwelling in them,
in the presence of those buddhas, at their feet,
he is seen abiding in peaceful absorption.
Having shown himself in equipoise in that direction,
the hero rises from it in all the fields of the east,
and is seen making manifold offerings
to all the Victors in their very presence.

In the same way, in the fields of the ten directions,
the steadfast one enters all directions without exception;
some are in equipoise while others stand,
and they are seen making offerings to the lamps of the world.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the eye,
and from the pathway of form the great being rises.
When he displays forms beyond conception,
the world with its gods is bewildered by it.
While in equipoise in the pathway of form,
he shows that the eye is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent;
and from the pathway of the eye the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the ear,
and from the pathway of sound the great being rises.
Before him the world with its gods is bewildered,
as he enters into all sounds and languages.
While in equipoise in the pathway of sound,
he shows that the ear is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent;
and from the pathway of the ear the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the nose,
and from the pathway of scent the great being is endowed.
Before him the world with its gods is bewildered,
as he enters fully into the supreme, sublime fragrance.
While in equipoise in the pathway of scent,
he shows that the nose is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent.

and from the pathway of the nose the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the tongue,
and from the pathway of all supreme flavors they rise.
Before him the world with its gods is bewildered,
as the great being is endowed with the supreme flavors.
While in equipoise in the supreme flavors,
he shows that the tongue is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent;
and from the pathway of the tongue the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the body,
and from the pathway of touch the great being rises.
Before him the world with its gods is bewildered,
as he enters into the touch that gives rise to happiness in the world.
While in equipoise in the pathway of touch,
he shows that the body is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent;
and from the pathway of the body the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the pathway of the mind,
and from the pathway of phenomena the great being rises.
Before him the world with its gods is bewildered,
as he fully enters the entry into abiding in phenomena.
While in equipoise in the pathways of phenomena,
he shows that the mind is by nature unborn and unarisen,
empty, without any agent;
and from the pathway of the mind the mindful one rises.

They are in equipoise in the body of a child,
and rise from those who abide in the full vigor of youth.
In equipoise in those who abide in the vigor of youth,
they rise from the body of one aged and bent.

In equipoise in the body of one aged and bent,
they rise from the body of a faithful laywoman.
In equipoise in the body of the faithful laywoman,
they rise from the body of a faithful layman.
In equipoise in the body of the faithful layman,
they rise from the body of a nun.
In equipoise in the body of the nun,
they rise from the body of a learned monk.
In equipoise in the body of the learned monk,
they rise from the body of one still training and one beyond training.
In equipoise in the body of one still training and one beyond training,
they rise from the body of a solitary buddha.
In equipoise in the body of the solitary buddha,
they rise from the supreme, excellent body of a buddha.
In equipoise in the supreme, excellent body of a buddha,
they rise from the bodily form of a god.
In equipoise in the bodily form of a god,
they rise from the body of a nāga of great miraculous power.
In equipoise in the body of the nāga of miraculous power,
they rise from the body of a yakṣa of great magical power.
In equipoise in the body of the yakṣa of great magical power,
they rise from the body of every kind of being.
In equipoise in the body of every kind of being,
they rise from a single pore of the skin.
In equipoise in a single pore,
they rise from all the pores.
In equipoise in all the pores,
they rise from the span of a single hair tip.
In equipoise in the span of a single hair tip,
they rise from the span of all the hair tips.
In equipoise in the span of all the hair tips,
they rise from a particle of the finest atomic dust.
In equipoise in a single particle,
they rise from all the particles without exception.
In equipoise in all the particles without exception,
they rise from the diamond foundation beneath the ocean.
In equipoise in the diamond foundation beneath the ocean,

they rise from the wish-fulfilling trees and their fruits.
In equipoise in these trees and fruits,
they rise from the doorway of the light rays of the Victors.
In equipoise in the doorway of the Victors' light rays,
they rise from the rivers and waters of the ocean.
In equipoise in the rivers and waters of the ocean,
the great being rises from the pathway of fire.
In equipoise in the pathway of fire,
the mindful one rises from the pathway of wind.
In equipoise in the pathway of wind,
the great being rises from the foundation of the earth.
In equipoise in the foundation of the earth,
they rise from the immeasurable palaces of all the gods.
In equipoise in the immeasurable palaces of all the gods,

Those mindful ones rise from the sky.

The meditative absorptions and liberations of those who have gathered
inconceivable qualities are beyond thought.

Though all the Victors speak of them for inconceivable eons, they do not bring
their exposition to an end.

The ripening of beings' karma is beyond thought as well, and so the Victors
have taught.

The magical displays of the nāgas, the magical displays of the buddhas, and
the magical displays of those who meditate through reflection and
concentration are all beyond thought.

Even so, I shall give examples to illustrate them.

Nothing at all exists that is truly like them,
yet when the wise and learned are shown examples, they quickly come to
understand the meanings.

A hearer who dwells in the power of the eight liberations,
being one, becomes many;

having become many, becomes one again.

In the sky he enters concentration, and he blazes forth.

From the lower body fire blazes and from the upper body flows a stream of
water;

from the upper body fire blazes and from the lower body flows a stream of
water.

Walking, standing, lying down, and sitting,
his bodily displays, within a single instant, are beyond thought.
Now suppose he lacked great compassion,
did not seek awakening, and abandoned the world to ruin.
If even such a one can show inconceivable bodily displays,
why would those who wish to benefit the world not show them?

The sun and moon move through the sky,
and in the clear surfaces of water in every direction,
in lakes, ponds, pools, vessels, and jewels,
in the oceans and in rivers, they show their reflections.
In just the same way, the bodies of the hero among men,
beyond thought, appear throughout all ten directions.
He is skilled in the ways of all absorptions and liberations;
over this the Tathāgata holds spontaneous mastery.

In a clear lake, an army of four divisions
sees each its own reflection:
swords, great arrows, bows and shafts,
armor, mounts, and vehicles all appear.
Whatever form, whatever place, whatever attire there may be,
each and every one is seen just so in the water.
Yet the water has no thought of love or hatred.
Such is the magical display of the sage's absorption.

The ocean goddess called Sound-Possessing
is skilled in the aspects of sound and the art of melody
for all beings born in the ocean,
and she satisfies every speech with its own language.
If she, Sound-Possessing, who is full of attachment, aversion, and delusion,
is skilled in the ways of all languages,
then why would those who have gained mastery over dhāraṇī and the power
of the Dharma
not satisfy the world with its gods?

Tumburu's wife, she of the lovely voice,
the daughter of Brahmā born from his mind,
enters the mind, the thoughts, and the mouths
of those who are truthful, vow-keeping, harmless, and joyful.

If she, Lovely-Voiced, who is full of attachment and aversion,
through her accomplished discipline and the elements of melody,
pleases the world with her enchanting speech,
why would those rich in the qualities of wisdom not do so?

The master illusionist, skilled in the ways of spells,
displays many varied forms without limit.
He shows day and night, moments, months, and a hundred years,
and he shows spacious, splendid, exceedingly beautiful houses.
If even an illusionist, full of attachment and anger,
pleases the world through his magical illusions,
why would those well trained in concentration, higher knowledges, and
liberations,
those skilled in conduct, not please it?

When the gods and asuras, led by their chiefs, do battle,
and the glorious god Indra defeats the asuras,
they flee in terror, together with their parasols,
their vehicles, their armies, and their armor,
squeezing into a single lotus fiber.
If those chiefs of the gods, full of attachment and anger,
can display inconceivable bodily magic,
why would the sovereign lords, the heroes with mastery of miraculous power,
not display bodily magic?

The elephant who holds the vajra, Pṛthivīpāla's son,
who belongs to Indra's retinue, great in miraculous power,

He manifests thirty-three heads,
and every one of those heads has six tusks,
and on each single one of those tusks
he conjures up seven pools filled with water.
In each pool he conjures up seven lotuses,
each with a varied and splendid array.
On each lotus he conjures up seven daughters of the gods,
masters of every art and illusion.
Skilled in play, in song, and in dance,
they sport with that lord, the thirty-three.
And that elephant too transforms his body

and mingles in company with all the gods.
In manner of conduct and in enjoyments he is wholly like them.
Such is the manifestation of that supreme elephant.

If an elephant who possesses attachment, anger, and delusion
can display such miraculous power,
why would those trained in the strength of wisdom and skillful means
not work wonders through hundreds of meditative absorptions?

Rāhu, the seizer of the moon, changes his body at will,
sets his feet upon the foundation of the vajra ground,
and appears to reach only to the middle of the ocean,
while his head rises level with the summit of Mount Meru.
If Rāhu too, who possesses attachment, anger, and delusion,
can display such miraculous power,
why would those who are lamps of the world, who crush the māras,
not display their boundless miraculous power?

The magical displays of Indra, the Hundred-Sacrificer, appear beyond all
thought.

When the gods and the lords of the asuras go to battle,
for as many millions of asuras as are scattered about,
Indra emanates that many forms from his own body.
Every lord of the asuras and every common asura
perceives Indra standing before himself alone.
"He has been seized by the wielder of the vajra!"
Thinking so, all the lords of the asuras reel, their minds bewildered.
He displays a thousand terrifying eyes,
and brandishes a vajra blazing with flame.
His body is armored, his splendor hard to approach.
Beholding Indra, the lords of the asuras flee.
If he, through the power of ordinary merit,
works such transformations for the sake of the king of the gods,
why would those whose inexhaustible merit
makes them the refuge of all beings not work transformations?

The divine drum that urges the gods on
was brought about by the ripening of the gods' own karma.
When it perceives that the gods are dwelling heedlessly,

that drum sounds out from the sky:

"All desires are impermanent, not everlasting,
fleeting, unstable, of the nature of a bubble,
like an illusion, like a mirage, like the moon's reflection in water.

All existence is like a dream, like a cloud.

All heedlessness is full of enemies and sorrow;
it is the path of death, not the path of deathlessness.

All who dwell in heedlessness
are seized by Lord Death, that great sea monster.

All that is grasped at is the root of suffering.

All birth is condemned by the noble ones.

You are deluded by the objects of the sensual pleasures.

Delight always in the power of the Dharma!"

Urged on by that drum, Indra and the gods
sit in the divine assembly hall, the Excellent Dharma,
and Indra speaks to all the gods
words of Dharma that are peaceful, free of desire, and fitting.

Though that drum is formless and cannot be shown,
if by its sound it accomplishes such great aims,
why would those who display forms according to the thoughts of beings
not accomplish the great aims of all beings?

When the gods and the lords of the asuras go to battle,
through the special power of the gods' merit
the sound of the drum that urges the gods on
cries out: "Gods, do not be afraid!"

Urged on by the drum, the gods rejoice greatly,
are free of fear, and strength arises in them.

The lords of the asuras, afflicted by terror,
panic and flee at once together with their armies.

Like that drum that sounds out in this way,
those who are the refuge, the support, and the antidote for all beings,
who have vanquished the māras of affliction and are rich in great compassion,
proclaim the sound of peace and dispel the afflictions.

The ninety-two daughters of the gods of the lord Indra...

By his emanation all are made glad;
though he is one, Indra knows how to play with each of them.
As with one, so too with all the goddesses.
He seems to dwell in delight with all the goddesses,
and likewise he seems to be seated in the Hall of Good Dharma.
He seems to teach the excellent Dharma to all the gods,
and in a single instant Indra manifests in many forms.
Indra, though he is endowed with attachment, aversion, and delusion,
can by emanation delight his own retinues.
Then why should those who work tirelessly for the welfare of beings
not please the world by the power of miraculous display?

Māra, the great disturber, who holds beings in his power,
leads all these sentient beings under his sway.
Entered fully into karma and affliction,
all ordinary beings are bound by that Māra.
And if even Māra, endowed with attachment, aversion, and delusion,
brings all beings under his power,
what need to speak of those who have attained the ten masteries?
They would never leave any being on the side of their own.

Brahmā, lord of the dwelling of the three thousand worlds,
is seen to be present in each Brahmā world
of all the Brahmā abodes that exist in the three thousand worlds,
and he proclaims the Brahmā voice, most pleasing to the mind.
If that Brahmā can work miraculous transformations
through the meditative concentrations and clairvoyances of the worldly
Brahmā path,
how could those who abide in the meditative liberations
that transcend the world, the unsurpassed, not work such wonders?

Behold the miraculous transformations of the knowledge of the Great Lord.
A cloud of the ocean scatters its drops of rain,
and in a single instant makes everything grow;
yet without it the rays of even a few drops would not be known.
So too those who trained through inconceivable aeons in the trainings
and attained the unsurpassed awakening, the primordial wisdom:
why, in a single instant of mind,
would they not know the minds of all beings without exception?

Because the ripening of beings' karma is beyond conception,
this entire world has arisen from the wind.
The oceans, the mountains, the celestial mansions,
the separate precious things, and even the scattered seeds arose.
From the wind clouds arise, and the rain falls everywhere;
by the wind the clouds are also completely stilled.
The ripening of the world's crops is also the work of the wind;
the wind brings forth benefit for all beings.
That wind has not trained in the perfections,
nor in the qualities of the buddhas,
yet it displays the inconceivable ripening of the world.
Why would those who have attained the sacred state not display it?

The waters of the thundering clouds of the ocean
carry the voices of birds, of wild animals,
of men, of women, of girls and boys, as many as there are,
and sound forth the pleasing voices of all to sentient beings.
Knowing thus that pleasing sounds have no intrinsic nature,
one becomes endowed with unobstructed eloquence,
and having spoken pleasing words to all beings,
one gladdens the world with a voice that delights the mind.

This ocean has marvelous and wondrous qualities:
it is called the ocean because it is vast like all beings;
its waters and its beings and its jewels are inexhaustible,
and it is never sated by receiving the waters of rivers.
In the same way, those great beings are vast like all beings, like the ocean:
their merit, meditative concentrations, and liberations,
their wisdom, primordial wisdom, and qualities are all inexhaustible,
and they are never sated with merit and qualities and the like.

When the nāga king of the ocean plays in many ways,
from the foundation of the earth up to the Heaven of Mastery over Others'
Emanations,
the great clouds spread and fill the four continents,
and all of them hold many varied arrangements.
In the Heaven of Mastery over Others' Emanations
he forms clouds of the golden color of Jambudvīpa.
In the Heaven of Delight in Emanation, the color of red pearl;
in Tuṣṭita, the color of the white lotus;

in the Heaven without Strife, deep blue like beryl;
in the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, like the essence of stone;
in the realm of the Guardians, the color of crystal.
In the ocean, hard and unbreakable like a vajra;
in the abode of the Kinnaras, like a mass of the finest incense;
in the abode of the nāgas, like the color of a lotus;
in the abode of the secret ones, the color of a peacock's dance;
in the abode of the asuras, the color of a rocky cliff.

In the north they show the radiance of golden light, and in the other continents they show arrays of every kind. In Jambudvīpa the clouds resemble blue mountains, as lofty as the mountains are, so too are the clouds. In the realm of the Masters of Others' Emanations, golden clouds appear, and lightning of sunlike color flashes forth. In the Heaven of Delight in Emanation, the clouds are like the fine light of the moon; in Tuṣita, like the golden color of Jambudvīpa. In the Heaven without Strife, they have the color of a swan; in the Thirty-Three, they are like golden radiance. In the realm of the Guardians, they have the color of the essence of splendor. In the ocean they are arrayed like the hue of red pearl. In the abode of the Kinnaras, a deep blue like beryl; in the abode of the nāgas, the color of the essence of splendor; in the abode of the secret ones, the color of crystal; in the abode of the asuras, like the essence of stone. In the north, the color of a jewel, like the colors of the stars. In the other continents too, arrays differ one from another. In Jambudvīpa a moon-jewel blazes, and lightning appropriate to the nature of the clouds flashes forth.

Then in the realm of the Masters of Others' Emanations, the voice of Brahmā resounds; in Delight in Emanation, the sound of drums is made. In Tuṣita, the sound of cymbals and music; in the Heaven without Strife, the voices of the daughters of the gods. In the Thirty-Three, the many voices of the Kinnaras; in the realm of the Guardians, the voices of the gandharvas. In the ocean, a sound like mountains clashing. In the abode of the Kinnaras, the sound of every flute; in the abode of the nāgas, the cry of the kalapiṅka bird; in the abode of the secret ones, the voices of the nāga maidens; in the abode of the asuras, the drumming of the gods; in the human realm, the sound of the ocean and of flutes.

Then in the realm of the Masters of Others' Emanations, fragrant divine incense and rains of flowers in every kind of arrangement come down. In Delight in Emanation, garlands of māṇḍārava flowers and ointments, like the

radiance of the fine moon, come down. In Tuṣita, there is the color of great jewels, the finest ornaments of many precious kinds, crown jewels like the moon, and a rain of silk the color of gold comes down. Banners, parasols, and flags of many kinds, garlands, ornaments, and ointments, red pearls, gold, and silk, and pleasing cymbals fall in the Heaven without Strife. In the Thirty-Three, the supreme wish-fulfilling jewel; in the realm of the Guardians, the supreme essence of sandalwood, saffron, cymbals, divine trees, and tamāla leaves; streams of perfumed water and flowers come down.

In the abode of the nāgas, that lord of the nāgas sends down food and drink that give strength and vigor, endowed with color, fragrance, and taste, and besides these, a rain of inconceivable jewels. Into the great ocean too the rain falls without interruption, in streams as thick as a plow-pole. The great inexhaustible treasures of Vaiśravaṇa, boundless arrays of jewels, come down as rain. In the abode of the Kinnaras come garlands of many kinds, lotuses, utpala flowers, cloth, and jewels, varṣikā and jasmine flowers, powder and incense, and rains of lutes, flutes, sweet sounds, and drums. In the abode of the nāgas, red pearls; in the secret abode, precious jewels like the color of stars. In the abode of the asuras come down great swords and arrows, bows to subdue enemies, and rains of spears. In the north come garlands of victory and jewels, garlands of varṣikā, jasmine, and campaka flowers, and kuruṇṭa and atimuktaka blossoms fall. In the other continents too, rains of many kinds come down.

In Jambudvīpa the rains come down clear and pure, in fine streams, as is fitting. They cause flowers, fruits, medicines, incense, trees, and crops that bring happiness to grow throughout the worlds. Thus, though the arrays of clouds are beyond thought, and though they send down rain with lightning, thunder, and arrays of marvels, the nāga stays unmoving in his place, without any conceptual thought. Such is the magical display of the nāgas, inconceivable.

Even though it dwells within the waters of the ocean, the nāga can display inconceivable magical wonders. How then could those rich in the qualities of one who has entered the ocean of the Dharma fail to display inconceivable wonders?

By these examples, spoken only in brief, praise has been offered to those great beings. Those heroes are free from every comparison; such liberated lives are theirs to command.

Those of excellent intelligence, of vast intelligence, of unerring intelligence, of boundless intelligence, possessed of supreme wisdom and of distinguished mind: it is the supreme liberated lives of such beings that are taught in this way.

Whoever hears these sacred accounts of liberation, holds them in trust, and proclaims them to the world, such persons are possessed of wonder and marvel in the Dharma. They bring delight in the human world. Those who have faith in a Dharma such as this are rare among the multitudes of ordinary beings. Those who have gathered virtue and made merit have faith in this through the power of their causes.

Even those people who trust the Vehicle of the Hearers are few in the human world. Fewer still are those who trust the vehicle of the solitary buddhas, and fewer than those are those in the Great Vehicle. Rare is the one who has entered the Great Vehicle. If even faith in this Dharma is so rare, what need is there to speak of entering it and holding it, or of practicing accordingly?

Suppose someone were to carry the three-thousandfold world, with its mountains and oceans, upon the head for the whole of a future aeon. However difficult that deed, it does not compare to the difficulty of having faith in this Dharma.

Suppose someone were to serve with every happiness, for aeons, as many beings as there are dust motes in the three-thousandfold world. The merit of faith in this Dharma surpasses that; no such distinction of merit is found in that service.

Suppose someone were to hold ten buddha-fields, with their mountains and oceans, in the palm of the hand for an aeon. However difficult that deed, it does not compare to the difficulty of having faith in this Dharma.

Suppose someone were to serve with every virtue, for aeons, as many beings as there are dust motes in ten buddha-fields. The merit of faith in this Dharma surpasses that; no such distinction of merit is found in that service.

Suppose someone were to honor with every happiness, for aeons, as many buddhas as there are dust motes in ten buddha-fields. The merit of one who has taken up this chapter of the Dharma is more excellent than that.

When those liberated lives were being taught, all the buddha-fields of the ten directions trembled. The abodes of Māra were shaken and shattered, and by the sounding of the sound the lower realms were utterly pacified. The lions

among men of all ten directions all appeared face to face. They stretched out their hands and placed them upon the head of the noble Glorious One, of boundless qualities. Stroking his head with the palms of their hands, they declared: "Well spoken! You have spoken well of these liberated lives. Following your fine teaching, we are delighted." Thus all those buddhas spoke.

Then the Blessed One, having spoken these verses, fell silent.

Then all the gods dwelling in this world-system of the great thousandfold three-thousandfold world, and all those humans and nonhumans, said: "The Tathāgata has spoken this well. Alas, the Tathāgata has turned this second wheel of the Dharma! Such a teaching of the Dharma has never been heard before. Those beings who come to obtain this Dharma discourse are exceedingly rare. Those beings do not possess poor roots of virtue. Those beings have served and honored many buddhas."

Those beings will become like a shrine for the world with its gods, its māras, and its Brahmās. Neither māras, nor the gods of the retinue of māras, nor those who have gone forth, nor householders, nor likewise kings, nor great ministers, nor lay patrons can harm them. So they cried out, with a clamor of shouts and uproar.

Then the venerable Subhūti said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, it is rare for sūtras as precious as these to appear in the world. And yet, by the power of the Tathāgata, such a Dharma has appeared in the world, and by the very power of the Tathāgata, those beings have also been able to hear it."

Then the Blessed One extended his tongue, and said to the venerable Ānanda: "Ānanda, you must hold this Dharma discourse. Retain it. Master it. Fully comprehend it."

Then the venerable Ānanda circumambulated the Blessed One three times and said this: "Blessed One, I have taken hold of this Dharma discourse, and from now on I shall not let it lapse."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, that entire retinue, together with the bodhisattvas, the noble bodhisattva Samantabhadra, Mañjuśrī, the youthful one, the venerable Śāriputra, and the other great hearers, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had spoken.

Thus ends the Dharma discourse called the Noble Dhāraṇī of the Precious Talala.

It was translated, revised, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Surendrabodhi and the great editor-translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

- The Sanskrit forms of the bodhisattva names are reconstructed from the Tibetan and should be treated as tentative; the English glosses follow the Tibetan. The opening colophon line of the preceding text and the Sanskrit title are rendered as given, though the Sanskrit title is somewhat corrupt ("Ratnolka" is the likely sense of the Tibetan "Konchok Ta la la," which appears to transliterate "Torch of the Jewels"). The term translated "Vulture Peak" is literally "Mountain of the Heap of Vultures." "Ratnamudrāhastā" and several other epithets are reconstructions; nothing doctrinal turns on them.
- The passage opens by continuing the description of the assembly of bodhisattvas begun in the preceding passage, so its first sentences describe those bodhisattvas rather than starting a new scene. The phrase "they were such as these, and many others besides" renders an obscure and probably corrupt clause, literally something like "abiding in the signless, together with a tiger"; the Tibetan appears to be a garbled rendering of a stock formula, and the sense given is the likely intended one. The dhāraṇī name "Tala-tala of the Jewel" is a tentative reconstruction of the Tibetan transliteration. The final exchange is abrupt; Mañjuśrī's reply, that the Tathāgatas do not rest in equanimity, is cut off here and continues in the following passage.
- The dhāraṇī title "Jewel Talala" (འཇམ་མཁའ་ལ་ལ་) is a transliterated name; the rendering follows the Tibetan and its Sanskrit form is uncertain. The phrase about asking "two syllables" (གཞན་གྱི་ལྟ་བུ་གཞན་གྱི་ལྟ་བུ་) is rendered literally and may be an idiom for a brief question. The sentence "if you know how to bring it to its proper time" is rendered tentatively. The sentence ending in "knowable" (མཐོང་པོ་) reads the word as the object of knowledge, in line with the sense of the question. The passage ends mid-speech, as the source does.
- The name འཇམ་མཁའ་ལ་ལ་ is rendered Matisāgara as a reconstruction of the bodhisattva's name; the Sanskrit form is not certain. The brahmin "like a great śāla tree" is a literal rendering of an unusual epithet, and the epithet may reflect a name or a simile in the underlying text. The phrase "rgyu mthun pa" (accord, in accord with, or concordant cause) is rendered as "in accord with" and "that which accords with," following the contextual sense.
- 1. "Fixed reference point" renders dmigs pa can, "one who has an object of focus"; the sense is that Mañjuśrī is showing that Śāriputra clings to some identity or position after denying every category.
- 2. The final sentence of this passage, Śāriputra addressing the Blessed One, is left unfinished, since the content of his speech continues in the next passage.
- 3. The simile of the "goad" describes the bull elephant being tamed by a small hook, as the Tibetan says. Śāriputra's self-deprecating example inverts the expected roles, with Mañjuśrī as the powerful elephant-tamer.
- The name of the absorption, dkon mchog ta la la sbyor ba mtha' yas pa, is rendered provisionally as Boundless Application, Engagement with the Jewel Tāla; the transliterated term "ta la" is obscure and possibly corrupt. The ten "settings" (rnam par gzhag pa bcu) are rendered literally and may correspond to a lost Sanskrit term for ten bodhisattva stages or topics. The phrase "khā na ma tho ba med pa" is rendered "freedom from fault," following the standard sense of "without blame."
- The ten items taken hold of are the ten powers of a Tathāgata (daśabala), and the list continues beyond this passage. "Settings" renders the Tibetan for the ten stages of a bodhisattva's career as laid out in this sūtra's own scheme, not the ten grounds proper. The

prince" renders རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་, the stage of the royal heir, the tenth ground. The line about "what he intentionally sets in motion" for རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ is a considered rendering of a compressed phrase.

- Several verses are syntactically obscure in the Tibetan, and I have rendered them according to the evident sense. The word "grounds" (sa) in the verse on how beings arise may carry the sense of "stages" or "bases." The first-person plural speech at the opening is the bodhisattvas from other worlds testifying that they are called by the same name, Dharma-Intelligence, which is why I have retained the repeated name. The final verse breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage, and I have left it as it stands.

- Several lines are corrupt or elliptical in the Tibetan. I translated them as sensibly as I could. The line about the "broad, vast tongue" (Ice yangs rgya chen) is probably a reference to the Buddha's wide tongue, but the construction is obscure. The line "phenomena as conceptual constructs" renders rnam rtog chos rnam, which may be corrupt. The line on "self-arisen phenomena" in the buddha-fields is also unclear. The final two lines are evidently the beginning of a new thought that continues in the next passage.

- In the first line, "divisions of speech" renders the Tibetan literally. The Tibetan "ལྟོགས་" may be an error for a term like "ལྟོགས་" or "ལྟོགས་," but I have kept the text as given. The final lines of the passage are corrupt or elliptical in the Tibetan, particularly the numbering of the kinds of bodhisattva (the first, the second beginner, and the third), so the rendering of that closing sequence is tentative. The list of "minds" (benefit, joy, kinship, and so on) renders a difficult series whose individual terms are uncertain.

- The passage breaks off mid-verse, so the final line is left open. Several lines are syntactically terse and unclear in the Tibetan; the enumeration of bodhisattva types (fourth, fifth) follows the text's own numbering. The line about the "self-arisen ones" (rang byung) I take as referring to buddhas who awaken on their own. The "bodhisattva born in the heart" (thugs skyes) is rendered literally.

- This section continues the earlier dedicatory verse sequence on the bodhisattva who does not turn back and the crown prince stage. The line "not come, or are not 'not come'" follows the Tibetan's double negation closely. The verse beginning "The one who is empowered" about the single son of the Sugata is somewhat compressed in the Tibetan; I have kept its imagery of the hair-tip and the ocean as given.

- The title and name of the dhāraṇī, dkon mchog ta la la, is kept in transliteration, since it is a phonetic mantra-like name rather than a translatable phrase; it relates to the word for the Jewel. The Dharmamati figure is rendered by the Sanskrit equivalent of Chos kyi blo gros. The Blessed One's silence is rendered as the text's gnang ba mdzad do, understood as a gesture of consent, though the precise sense of this phrase is slightly ambiguous. Śāriputra's honorific "elder" renders gnas brtan.

- The mantra title "Dkon mchog ta la la" is left as in the continuity text; it is a transliteration of an unclear Sanskrit original. Several names in the hearers' list are Tibetan renderings whose Sanskrit equivalents I have reconstructed: རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Cūḍapanthaka; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Nadikāśyapa; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Uruvilvākāśyapa; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Mahākauṣṭhila; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Bhadrīka; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Revata; རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ as Aniruddha. The nun རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་ in the divine assemblies is rendered as Yāma (a likely reading of the Tibetan). The nun "Grags 'dzin" is rendered Yaśodharā. The phrase "རྒྱལ་ཁབ་ཀྱི་ཁོ་སྒྲོལ་པ་" is rendered as an exhortation not to feel small, which is an interpretive choice.

- The Tibetan reads "Śāradvatīputra" throughout, rendered here as such; the first mention is glossed as Śāriputra for continuity with the preceding list. "Jewel Talala" renders dkon mchog ta la la, a Sanskrit-derived title left as a name. The phrase "wheel-turning kings of power" follows the Tibetan stobs kyi 'khor los sgyur ba. The Tibetan in the passage on "illusory creation" is

"Heroic Progress" renders dpa' bar 'gro ba, likely sūraṅgama or a similar absorption; I have given a plain translation of the Tibetan. The "four assemblies" are the standard fourfold community of monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen.

- [illegible]

opening question reads "chos du" (probably "how many qualities"), so I rendered it that way. The Tibetan phrase "because it is profound" after each aggregate is circular in the source and was kept literally, as it is evidently the sūtra's own rhetorical style. The name Ānanda renders Kun dga' bo, and the phrase "the last of the five hundred years" follows the Tibetan literally. The passage ends mid-sentence, as given.

- The mantra-like syllables "Ala-la" are rendered as transliteration. The title of the dhāraṇī, rendered here "Jewel-Supreme Ala-la," follows the Tibetan dkon mchog ta la la; the Sanskrit original is uncertain. The name of the past Tathāgata is rendered by meaning from the Tibetan epithet string. The final simile is left open at the end of the passage, as the Tibetan breaks off there, so the sentence continues in the following passage.
- The phrase "this is my Teacher" (བོད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་ཁབ་) is rendered literally; it presumably means this Dharma exposition stands in the Buddha's place after his passing. The sentence "I will make amends for what I have done" (ངས་ཀྱི་མཚན་ཉིད་ཀྱི་འཕྲུག་པ་ལ་ཐུག་ཅིང་།) is slightly obscure; it may mean he will repay or acknowledge the kindness done to him. "Īśvara" follows the abbreviated epithet of Avalokiteśvara (འཕགས་པ་ལྷ་མོ་).
- Samantabhadra's name appears here for the first time in this passage; the opening "they will engage in all kinds of sinful actions" continues the description of the corrupt renunciants. The text's mdo ("this sūtra") and chos kyi rnam grangs ("Dharma discourse") are rendered distinctly. The verses recall the opening scene of the Avataṃsaka (Buddhāvataṃsaka), which is why I give the absorption as "Buddha Avataṃsaka, the Great Garland," a restoration of sangs rgyas phal chen. "Bhadraśrī" renders bzang po'i dpal and "Śrī" renders dpal in the line naming the buddha-sons; "Śrī" in the plural there is a loose rendering. "Self-arisen" (rang byung) is ambiguous between describing the Buddha and the mind of awakening, and I have kept the Tibetan's ambiguity. In the question verse the identity of the questioner and the answerer is slightly tangled in the Tibetan, and I have followed the most natural reading.
- The line "ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་འཕྲུག་པ་ལ་ཐུག་ཅིང་།" is almost certainly a scribal error for "ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་འཕྲུག་པ་ལ་ཐུག་ཅིང་།", and I have rendered it "likewise." In the second stanza, "ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་འཕྲུག་པ་ལ་ཐུག་ཅིང་།" is read as "clarity and devotion." The line "faith is a treasure, wealth, and the best of feet" is rendered literally. The following line, with its image of hands gathering virtue, shows that the metaphor of faith as bodily limbs is intended.
- The final line is left unfinished because the passage ends mid-sentence; the following verse will presumably complete the chain.

In the line on "equal engagement and non-engagement," the Tibetan reads "mñam žiñ sbyor dang mi sbyor." I have rendered it literally; the exact referent, possibly equanimity and its opposite or a pair of practice-categories, is unclear without the Sanskrit.

In the line on seeing the buddhas "beyond all reckoning" (bsam yas), I took the reading as seeing buddhas inconceivably or immeasurably many.

- [illegible]

Terms such as "कुम्भहण्डा" (kumbhāṇḍa) are given in the Sanskrit-derived sense. The "great Buddha-assembly samādhi" renders "बुद्धावतामसका" (buddhāvataṃsaka), as a samādhi name. The passage ends mid-sentence, continuing in the next section.

- The passage continues the description of the samādhi of magical display of offerings. In the final stanzas the Tibetan phrase for the "great multitudes" (ཆེན་པོ་མང་པོ་) of each offering is rendered as a great multitude; the term སྒྲུབ་པོ་ I have rendered "clusters," following the sense of heaped or massed offerings. The word rendered "great beings" in the refrain (ཆེན་པོ་སྒྲུབ་པོ་) refers to the great-souled bodhisattvas who perform the offerings. In the line about "the lamps of the world" the Victors are meant.

- The final line is cut off mid-sentence in the source, so I have rendered it only as far as the Tibetan allows. The line about the "door of benefiting others by the means of gathering disciples" renders bsdu ba'i dngos po, the four means of gathering disciples (saṃgrahavastu). The phrase "life-force" translates srog med, the standard companion to selflessness. In the line on those who "cannot be grasped as a fixed characteristic," mtshan mar gzung is rendered as grasping at a sign or fixed mark.

- Several lines are difficult and the rendering is tentative: "those with the Naked Ones and the thirty tīrthika sects" (gle'u can) and "those who dwell on pestles and beds of wood" are uncertain. The phrase "form body" renders gzugs kyi byin rlabs and may be intended more generally as the blessing of form. The line "Soon after they have appeared in the world, they come to know" is elliptical in the Tibetan, and its subject is uncertain. The bodhisattva's assuming of tīrthika practices is understood as skillful means for taming beings, not as endorsement of those views.

- The verse is in a loose, partly corrupt Tibetan, and I translated the sense where the syntax is obscure. The beings listed in the speech catalogue (འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་, འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་) are rendered with their standard Sanskrit equivalents. The phrase "those who move through the sky" for the first mantra foundation is uncertain. The rays named "Good to See" and "Light-Maker" are descriptive names rendered from the context. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end.

- The refrain "may I become self-arisen" (rang byung) follows the continuity passage. The verse beginning "Diligent in the Three Jewels" repeats nearly verbatim in the Tibetan; I preserved the repetition rather than collapse it. The last section's heading (འོ་མ་ or the like) is not named explicitly in the Tibetan; the ray's name, "that possesses ascetic discipline" (sbyangs dang ldan pa), is rendered literally and could alternatively be read as "purification" or "austerity."

- The ten verse-units here each describe a ray of light and its cause. The verse on liberation and the faculties ("truths, steadfastness, modes of liberation, knowledge of the faculties") appears twice in the Tibetan; I have rendered it once. The line "འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་" I take as the time when the Dharma is exhausted or declining. The deathless-giving ray is cut off mid-passage, so its sentence ends where the source does.

- The verses are in a cumulative sequence: each light is sent forth, benefits beings, and is explained as the result of a corresponding offering or practice. In the passage on jewels, the line about people being gathered in by the jewels of the afflictions is obscure; I have rendered it literally. "Great serenity" renders the phrase translated literally as "very pure" or "very clear-minded"; the sense of settled clarity is intended. The passage on the nose, with its "never smelled before," is a literal rendering of a difficult line.

- The final verse is slightly elliptical in the Tibetan; I have rendered its sense (that such faithful listeners are free of doubt about their own future qualities) rather than the literal repetition. In the first stanza of the series, "all who are mad regain their minds" takes འོ་མ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ལྔ་ as "possessed of mind," that is, restored to sanity. "Sages" (ཆེན་པོ་སྒྲུབ་པོ་) here refers to the great beings, the bodhisattvas, whose pores emit the rays. The line about the blind and the sun is rendered as a simile for those obstructed by wrong views.

- In the second stanza, the Tibetan line about the "long, graceful bodies" (ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་, apparently a rendering of an epithet for the buddhas' sons) is somewhat obscure, and I have rendered it by sense. The phrase about "the intermediate ones" (ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་) is likewise unclear in this context and may be a corrupt or idiosyncratic rendering. The passage ends mid-sequence, with the pathway of scent left without its closing line about rising from it; the following lines presumably continue with tongue, body, and mind.
 - The passage opens by completing the preceding line about the nose. The Tibetan has some irregular repetitions and a few scribal variants, such as "rnam par" for "rnam par" and the stray space in "mnyam par bzhaḡ", which do not affect the sense. In the line about the body of a laywoman, the verb of rising is supplied from the parallel structure. The passage ends mid-sequence, so the final line of equipoise has no matching rising line yet; it continues in the following passage.
 - Line three of the first verse group follows the Tibetan "ripening of beings' karma" as a distinct topic. The verse about the asuras' flight is rendered as the Tibetan reads, with the lotus-fiber detail supplied from the well-known parallel in the Avataṃsaka tradition. "Pṛthivīpāla's son" renders ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་, with the vajra-holding elephant presumably the elephant king; the sentence continues into the next passage. The name Tumburu follows the Tibetan transcription ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་.
 - The elephant is Airāvaṇa, Indra's mount, and "Pṛthivīpāla's son" in the preceding lines is in the same context. The drum is the divine drum of Sudharmā, the assembly hall, whose name is rendered here as the Excellent Dharma. "Hundred-Sacrificer" renders the epithet of Indra (Śatakratu), given by the Tibetan "brgya byin"; I clarify it once here for the listener. The final line breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage and continues in the next section.
 - This passage appears to derive from a Tibetan rendering of a sūtra on the great deeds of bodhisattvas, most likely a Gaṇḍavyūha-related text. The Tibetan is textually difficult in places. The renderings "the Great Lord" for the ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ line and "the secret ones" (guhyaka) for ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ are tentative. The cloud-color sequence is partly corrupt or abbreviated, and the placement of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three and the Guardians is uncertain. The phrase "like the essence of stone" is a literal rendering and may conceal a specific gem.
 - The sequence of heavens and abodes is rendered as the Tibetan gives it; the Tibetan sometimes lists the colors in a different order than the preceding English passage, and the divine realms follow the Tibetan names: dbang sgyur is the Masters of Others' Emanations, dga' ldan is Tuṣita, 'thab bral is the Heaven without Strife, skyong ba is the realm of the Guardians. The passage's misc ci is rendered Kinnara, and gsang ba as the abode of the secret ones (guhyaka), following the preceding passage. The identification of rnam rgyal chen po as Vaiśravaṇa is by the Tibetan name for his treasuries. Some plant names are transliterated where the identification is uncertain.
 - The recurring name "Glorious One" renders ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་, probably "Bhadraśrī" or an epithet of a bodhisattva; the identity is not certain from this passage alone. The lines on the "vehicle of conditions" (ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་) are read as the pratyekabuddha vehicle, following the standard three-vehicle sequence.
 - The Tibetan "ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་ ལྷན་པོ་ལྷན་པོ་" (hold, retain, master) is a standard triad of exhortations; I rendered it in that sense. The title is given as it appears in the Tibetan colophon, with "Talala" kept as a transliteration of the dhāraṇī's name. The opening sentence continues the preceding statement about those beings, so "they cried out" refers to the assembled gods and others who proclaimed this.
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Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.